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Flags, placards and a wall of barricades

Rahul, Priyanka lead Opposition march towards SC over electoral issues

ABHINAV KUMAR JHA
New Delhi

Three layers of police barricades stood between the INDIA bloc's march and the Supreme Court on Monday, as Opposition leaders and supporters moved through Central Delhi carrying flags and placards.

The procession advanced along Barakhamba Road toward Bhagwan Das Road, where security personnel were positioned to prevent the crowd from moving further. Rahul Gandhi, Priyanka Gandhi Vadra and other Opposition leaders led the mobilisation, which halted at a police blockade as the alliance sought to take its protest over electoral issues to the country's highest court.

The march, organised under the banner "Chalo Delhi: March for Democracy," drew political leaders, party workers and student groups into the heart of the Capital. The stretch between Connaught Place and Mandi House filled steadily with demonstrators through the morning, as security arrangements extended across the surrounding roads in anticipation of the procession's approach to the court.

Rahul Gandhi led the march alongside his sister Priyanka and Neha Bora, president of the All India Students' Association. Other opposition figures joined the procession, including Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav and Rashtriya Janata Dal leader Tejashwi Yadav. Supporters from the Congress, the Indian Youth Congress, the National Students' Union of India and Left-affiliated student groups swelled the crowd as it pushed forward.

The mobilisation carried a visible mix of political workers and student participants, moving together behind a wall of flags and placards. At several points, demonstrators climbed onto police vehicles, waving national and party flags as the crowd pressed through barricaded stretches of road, a striking, almost defiant image against the grey backdrop of security cordons.

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Congress leaders Rahul Gandhi, Priyanka Gandhi Vadra and INDIA bloc leaders proceed in a bus towards the Supreme Court during 'March for Democracy' in New Delhi PANKAJ KUMAR

Jantar Mantar out, three new protest sites in

New Delhi: After decades as one of India's most prominent places to voice dissent, Jantar Mantar in the high-security Central Delhi area will no longer serve as a designated protest venue. Delhi Police has named three new venues as designated protest sites. These are Ramlila Ground, Burari Ground, and CBD Ground in East Delhi.

The Delhi Police decision has prompted the Opposition parties to criticise the Government as a bid by the Centre to stop democratic protests. At the same time, the traders' body welcomed the Centre's decision to de-notify Jantar Mantar as a designated protest site, saying the move would reduce inconvenience to the public and businesses in the Delhi. However, the traffic situation in the areas near Jantar Mantar, which is also close to several important Government buildings, may improve for the general public.

CONTINUED ON >> P4



SIR row: Rahul seeks interim stay from SC

RAJESH KUMAR
New Delhi

Leader of the Opposition Rahul Gandhi, along with INDIA bloc leaders, reached the Supreme Court, seeking an interim stay on the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls and alleged poll irregularities.

The Supreme Court said the petition has 14 "defects", including a ₹220 shortfall in court fees. The Supreme Court also cited missing authorisations from nine petitioners and an illegible photocopy of Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge's identity card.

According to sources, the registry asked the filing lawyer to submit a clear copy of the ID card of Congress president and Leader of Opposition in the Rajya Sabha, Mallikarjun Kharge, who is one of the co-petitioners in the case.

The registry listed objections including the failure to attach certain "*vakalatnamas*" (written legal documents), the requirement to submit a clear copy of Mallikarjun Kharge's identity card, and other discrepancies, including "small fonts" and the non-submission of "coloured copies" for two particular documents.

The Supreme Court registry also noted issues with dim or illegible text, missing pages, vernacular pages, and discrepancies in the numbering of certain pages.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

Rahul Gandhi spreading chaos in India: BJP

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

The BJP mounted a fierce attack against Rahul Gandhi on Monday, accusing him of creating chaos and instability in the country and alleging that his actions were aimed at undermining constitutional institutions and tarnishing India's image globally.

Levelling these charges against him in a press conference on a day when Rahul Gandhi joined several other



Opposition leaders in a march to the Supreme Court, BJP MP Anurag Thakur said the country had never witnessed such "theatrics and tantrums" from a leader of the Opposition, whom he described as "destabilising, chaotic and unserious".

CONTINUED ON >> P4

The ByStander



TAMIL NADU, KERALAM GET NEW GOVERNORS

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

In a major gubernatorial reshuffle effected by President Droupadi Murmu on Monday, the Keralam Governor Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar has been appointed as the Governor of Tamil Nadu. At the same time, Om Prakash Mathur, Governor of Sikkim, will be the new Governor of Keralam in place of Arlekar.

According to a communique issued by the Rashtrapati Bhavan, senior BJP leader Dushyant Gautam has been appointed the Governor of Sikkim, while another BJP leader from Jharkhand, Braj Mohan Ram,



BJP leader Dushyant Gautam appointed Sikkim Governor

has been appointed as the Governor of Odisha.

While Sudha Yadav has been named the Governor of Karnataka, Dhal Singh Bisen will be the new Uttarakhand Governor. These appointments will take effect from the dates they assume charge of their respective offices, it added.

Four killed in suspected LoC blast in J&K

MOHIT KANDHARI ■ Jammu

At least four people were killed, and a few others were injured in a suspected Improvised Explosive Device (IED) explosion along the Line of Control (LoC) in the Krishna Ghati sector of Jammu and Kashmir's Poonch district on Monday.

The suspected blast was reported in the forward area around 4.00 p.m. The circumstances leading to the powerful explosion in the Satwal-Naki area near the zero line were yet to be established.

Till the time of filing the report, it could not be ascertained whether a group of terrorists, attempting to infiltrate inside Indian Territory, bore the brunt of the powerful explosion or regular soldiers of the Pakistan Army were patrolling in the area at the time of the IED blast in the forward area.

Ground reports claimed Indian troops were kept in a state of high alert following reports of a major infiltration bid in the KG sector of Poonch. The suspected movement of a large group was also detected by alert troops in the forward area, following which a powerful blast rocked the area, in which at least four people suffered fatal injuries, and a few others were injured.

"Following the explosion, security forces sounded an alert across the sector and intensified vigilance along the LoC to assess the situation and prevent any possible security breach," officials said.

CONTINUED ON >> P4



Ye mera mudda nahin hai: CJI

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

Drawing the lines clear between institutions, a day after declining to meet INDIA bloc leaders, the Chief Justice of India (CJI) on Monday asserted that the Supreme Court cannot be dragged into a "political battlefield" and said its doors were open to everyone through the legal route.

He also refused to be drawn into the issue of the current spate of protests against the Chief Election Commissioner, stating, "*Ye mera mudda nahin hai*. (This matter does not pertain to my domain,



adding that it was related to law and order in reply to a media query.

During an interaction with reporters on the sidelines of an event commemorating the 33rd anniversary of the National Human Rights Commission (NHRC) at Vigyan Bhawan here, the CJI declined to divulge reasons for refusing to meet Congress leaders over the issue of "vote chori".

CONTINUED ON >> P4

JNU sacking, then FIR: Congress MP faces harassment charges

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH
New Delhi

What began as quiet complaints whispered among students at Jawaharlal Nehru University (JNU) has now exploded into a formal criminal case. Days after the university abruptly dismissed him, Congress Lok Sabha MP Angomcha Bimol Akoijam has been booked by Delhi Police on charges of sexual harassment and insulting a woman's modesty.

Delhi Police registered an FIR on Sunday night at Vasant Kunj North police station under Sections 75, 75(1)(i), 75(1)(iv), and 79 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita. JNU's Chief Security Officer filed the complaint, submitted documents from the university's Internal Committee, and requested legal action. Akoijam, who was a professor at the Centre for the Study of Social Systems until last week, was dismissed from his post effective immediately on October 9.

The decision, signed by Vice-Chancellor Santishree D Pandit, followed the Internal Committee's recommendation of a severe penalty after it reviewed complaints submitted by 11 female students.



Congress Lok Sabha MP Angomcha Bimol Akoijam

CONTINUED ON >> P4



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Voter list: 20 lakh discrepancies resolved, says Delhi CEO

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

Around 20 lakh of the 33 lakh entries flagged for logical discrepancies or unmapped details in Delhi's voter list have been resolved, according to the Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) of Delhi. The CEO Delhi has assured that every eligible elector who submits Form-6 with the required documents will be included in the electoral rolls of the NCT of Delhi.

In a post on X, the official account of the Chief Electoral Officer shared, "Regarding Special Intensive Revision (SIR) 2026. About 33 lakh entries in Delhi voter list were under Logical Discrepancy/ Un-mapped. We had started a proactive campaign to resolve these issues. By now around 20 lakh cases out of 33 lakh have been resolved."

The CEO Delhi said any person with a grievance can approach any of the 14,947 Booth Level Officers (BLOs), 902 Assistant Electoral Registration Officers (AEROs), 70 Electoral Registration Officers (EROs), 13 District Election Officers (DEOs) or the CEO. Special camps were held on October 11 at all polling station locations in Delhi. BLOs present there assisted electors who came for electoral services. The CEO's office said similar camps for registering left-out electors will continue during the ongoing SIR. The next camps will be held on October 18 and 25. All unenrolled eligible voters have again been asked to come forward, visit the camps or contact their ERO, AERO or BLO, fill Form-6 and get enrolled in the electoral roll of their constituency.


Representative image

Form-6 can be submitted in two ways. Offline, it can be handed to the ERO, AERO or BLO, or at designated locations (polling stations), between August 31 and October 30, 2026. Online, it can be filed at voters.eci.gov.in or through the ECINET mobile app.

According to the bulletin, 2,12,400 Form-6 applications were received up to August 30. Another 2,17,391 were received from August 31 to October 11. Form-6A applications stood at 1,351 up to August 30 and 388 in the later period. Form-7 applications were 51,471 up to August 30 and 8,295 from August 31 to October 11. Form-8 was filed 2,60,768 times up to August 30 and 81,615 times in the later period.

Among the 13 districts, West recorded the highest Form-6 count up to August 30, at 28,820. South East followed with 24,923 and North East with 24,491. West also led from August 31 to October 11, with 26,830 applications. North West was second with 22,932 and South East third with 21,188. New Delhi had the lowest Form-6 numbers in both periods, at 2,322 and 3,662.

Women students flag safety concerns with CM

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



Student representatives of various women's colleges in the city flagged women's safety issues during an interaction with Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Monday, stressing adequate street lighting, safety audits, illumination of dark spots, deployment of female police personnel and regular patrols on campuses.

The chief minister, during the interaction at Mukhyamantri Jan Seva Sadan, assured the students that their concerns would be followed up with necessary action.

She asked the students to use the emergency helpline number, 112, to seek police assistance in an emergency.

She also told them that work is underway to install around one lakh smart streetlights across Delhi, which would be connected to the Integrated Command and Control Centre.

During the meeting, students suggested setting up safety committees in every college comprising the principal, student representatives and local police officers. They also called for regular safety audits and monitoring of streetlights, CCTV cameras, pink booths and hostel facilities.

Adequate public transport, CCTV surveillance and grievance redressal at college levels, were also sought by the student representatives, the Delhi Chief Minister's Office said in a statement.

Student representatives belonged to Lady Shri Ram College, Gargi College, Daulat Ram College, Jesus and Mary College, Maitreyi College, Aditi Mahavidyalaya, Bharati College, Janki Devi Memorial College and other institutions.

The chief minister said the suggestions shared by the students would be taken up with the concerned officials, and that necessary coordination and follow-up would be ensured to address their issues.

She further said that a WhatsApp group created to facilitate communication and coordination between students and officials would remain active, enabling students to share their concerns directly and ensuring timely action. The CM said if a complaint is not addressed at the appropriate level, students can also approach senior police officers and officials of the concerned departments. She emphasised that effective grievance redressal and ensuring students' safety remain priorities for the Government.

The students also suggested strengthening security in areas with a large student population, including Siri Fort Road, Kamala Nehru College, Gargi College, Mukherjee Nagar and Batra Cinema, and curbing inappropriate activities in public places.

They stressed the need for better coordination among the concerned departments to ensure safe movement around metro stations, on roads near colleges and across bridges.

CJP seeks protest date at Jantar Mantar, gives 24-hour ultimatum to Delhi Police

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

CJP leaders Ashutosh Ranka and Saurav Das went to Parliament Street police station on Monday to seek a date for a peaceful protest at Jantar Mantar.

Speaking to the media outside the police station, the CJP leaders said they will give the police a 24-hour ultimatum, or they will issue another call to protest. Police tightened security in the area and the road outside the police station was closed as the two leaders arrived. A public announcement was made outside the police station, asking people to comply with security restrictions and prohibitory orders, maintain peace and avoid unauthorised gatherings.

"We are going to ask Delhi Police for a date to hold a protest at Jantar Mantar. We hope the police will give us a date. If they do not, we will make another call within 24 hours," Ranka said.



Criticising the security restrictions in the national capital, Ranka said the arrangements affected residents and businesses, particularly with festivals approaching.

"The way Delhi Police has shut the entire national capital down is unprecedented. People are suffering, businesses have been shut...festivals are also coming. Why don't you give us a designated site to hold the protest?" Ranka said.

CJP leader Saurav Das said peaceful protest was a constitutional right and urged the police to specify a date and time for the demonstration. "Peaceful protest is a right, a constitutional right, and people are already exercising it. People will protest peacefully. The police always complain that we should approach them 10 days in advance. We are now leaving the choice to them and asking them to specify the date and time.

However, we will not let them keep the matter pending. We will give them a 24-hour ultimatum. Let's see," Das said.

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SYMBOLIC POSSESSION NOTICE

NOTICE is hereby given under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of powers conferred under Section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, the Authorized Officer issued demand notice to the borrower(s) on the date mentioned against the account stated hereinafter calling upon them to repay the amount within 60 days from the date of receipt of said notice. The borrower(s) having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular the borrower(s) that the undersigned has taken the symbolic possession of the property described herein below under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said Rules on the date mentioned against the account. The borrower(s) in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealing with the property will be subject to the charge of the Bank for the amounts, interest, costs and charges thereon. The borrowers'/mortgagors' attention is invited to the provisions of sub-section (8) of Section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets.

Name of borrower(s), Guarantor & Loan Account No.	Description of the property mortgaged (Secured Asset)	Date of Demand Notice	Date of Symbolic Possession Notice	O/s Amount as on date of Demand Notice
Mrs. Komal Devi W/O Dinesh Kumar Mr. Dinesh Kumar 71180000009453	All The Piece And Parcel Of Plot Measuring 41.5 Sq Yards I.E. 34-70 Sq Meter Situated In Khasra No.1065,Village0-Begma Bad Budana,Dharampuri Pargana-Jalalabad,The-Modinagar, Ghaziabad. Owned By Komal Devi W/O Dinesh Kumar And Same Bounded As Under: North: Plot Rakesh, East: Plot Sharif, West: Plot Raj Koli, South: Road 12 Ft Wide	October 31, 2025	October 09, 2026	Rs.2,36,342.85 (As On October 10, 2025)
Mr. Amol Bhatia S/O Surendra Kumar Bhatia Mrs. Rinkle Bhatia W/O Sh. Amol Bhatia 90001276153688 90001238115817	All That Piece Or Parcel Of Admeasuring About 1495.00 Sq. Ft. Bearing Plot No. B-170/A (Part of The Property B-170 Southern Side), Reg. Doc. No. 2024/15/I/12841 Dated 04.09.2024 In S.R.O-VI A, Pitampura Situated At First Floor, Derawal Nagar, Delhi-110009.,110009. Owned By Mrs. Rinkle Bhatia W/O Sh. Amol Bhatia , Amol Bhatia S/O Surendra Kumar Bhatia And Same Bounded As Under: North: Remaining Half Portion Of Property No. B-170, East: Property No.B-169, West: Road 30 Ft. Wide, South: Service Lane	April 30, 2026	October 08, 2026	Rs.19,641,855.85 (As On April 08, 2026)
Mr. Satish Kumr Jain S/O Inder Sen Jain Mrs. Shalu Gupta W/O Mr. Satish Kumar Jain 70190000004976	All That Part And Parcel Of Built Up Property Bearing No. RZ-80, Land Area Measuring 55 Sq. Yds. Out Of Khasra No. 348 & 351 Situated In Revenue Estate Of Village-Nisarpur, Colony-West Sagarpur, New Delhi-11046 Owned By Mr. Satish Kumar Jain With All The Free Hold Rights Of The Land Underneath. Owned By Mr. Satish Kumar Jain S/O Mr. Inder Sen Jain And Same Bounded As Under: North: Road 20 Ft, East: Other's Property, West: Other's Property, South: Other's Property	September 20, 2025	October 08, 2026	Rs.8,80,999.68 (As On September 09, 2025)
Mr. Girraj Kumar S/O Jagvir Mrs. Rashmi 71180000007077	All The Piece And Parcel Of Residential House Situated At Village Tugalpur,Pargana-Dankour, Teh And Distt-Gautambuddha Nagar One Storey No-2,Street No-3,West Facing,Whose Measurment Is 18 Feet 3 Inch In East And 18 Feet 3in Ch In West Side,39 Feet On The North Side Thus The Total Area Is 79.08 Sq Yard I.E. 66.12 Sq Mtr. Owned By Girraj Kumar S/O Jagvir And Same Bounded As Under: North: House Kamlesh, East: Road Gali 10 Feet Wide, West: House Patram, South: House Of Shahi	October 31, 2025	October 08, 2026	Rs.7,92,650.76 (As On October 10, 2025)

Place: Ghaziabad-Delhi-Gautambuddha Nagar
Date: October 13, 2026
Authorised Officer
Bandhan Bank Limited

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is to inform to the public at large that Mr. Pawan Chauhan had acquired Residential House Plot measuring 120 sq. yrds., out of Khasra No 456, at Old abadi of Village Sadarpur, Pargana and Teshil Dadri Dist Gautam Buddha Nagar Uttar Pradesh vide Gift Deed dated 06.01.2026 executed by Mr. Prem Singh, document no.164. Now Mr. Pawan Chauhan is the undisputed owner of above said property and willing to Mortgage the above said property with CIFCL.

OR

Any person / firm / institution / company having any claim or right in respect of the said Property by way of inheritance, share, sale, agreement, lease, license, gift, possession, legal heirs, partners or encumbrance howsoever or otherwise is hereby required to intimate in writing to the undersigned within 07 days from the date of publication of this notice of his/her/their share or claim, if any, with all supporting documents at below mentioned address. After expiration of notice period, the claims, if any, of such person shall be treated null and void and also treated as waived and not binding on our client.

Ajay Kumar Giri (Advocate) H No. 26/161, Basement, Vikram Vihar, Lajpat Nagar 4, New Delhi -110024

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is to inform to the public at large that Mr. Anil Chaudhary had acquired Residential Property No. B-148 (Old Plot No. 33), measuring 50 sq. yrds., Gali No. 1, in Khasra No. 95, (Khasra nos. mentioned in proeprty docs are 82min, 83, 84min, 86min, 91min, 92min, 93min & 94min), at unauthorized colony Maidan Garhi Extension, in village Maidan Garhi, Chattarpur Road, New Delhi vide Conveyance Deed (PM Uday Cell) dt. 18.03.2025 executed by POI. Now Mr. Anil Chaudhary is the undisputed owner of above said property and willing to Mortgage the above said property with CIFCL.

OR

Any person / firm / institution / company having any claim or right in respect of the said Property by way of inheritance, share, sale, agreement, lease, license, gift, possession, legal heirs, partners or encumbrance howsoever or otherwise is hereby required to intimate in writing to the undersigned within 07 days from the date of publication of this notice of his/her/their share or claim, if any, with all supporting documents at below mentioned address. After expiration of notice period, the claims, if any, of such person shall be treated null and void and also treated as waived and not binding on our client.

Ajay Kumar Giri (Advocate) H No. 26/161, Basement, Vikram Vihar, Lajpat Nagar 4, New Delhi -110024

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given on behalf of my client, **M/s Hayward Tyler India Pvt. Ltd.** (C-54, 3rd Floor, Okhla Industrial Area, Phase-I, New Delhi110020), that it is about to execute a Lease Deed with M/s Fidelity Engineers Pvt. Ltd. (E-11/3, Vasant Vihar, New Delhi-110057) for Industrial Plot & Building No. 49, Sector-59, HSIIDC, Faridabad, Haryana (Conveyance Deed No. 3382 dated 27.06.2011, Sub-Registrar Ballabgarh), admeasuring approx. 3915 sq mtrs, for 9 years. Objections/claims, if any, including by way of sale, mortgage, gift, inheritance, or family arrangement, may be sent with proof to the undersigned within 7 days, failing which the lease shall be executed and no claim entertained thereafter.

Shilpy Kaushik, Advocate
Seat No. 193, District & Sessions Court, Sector-12, Faridabad
M: 8447098023 | Email: Shilpybadal@gmail.com

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is to inform to the public at large that **Shri Sharat Madan** who is the owner of **House no. 272, area measuring 500 sq. yds., SECTOR-9 URBAN ESTATE FARIDABAD -121002.** Vide Sale Deed Dated 29.03.2004 executed by Smt. Harvinder Jeet Kaur in favour of Shri Sharat Madan in respect of House no. 272, area measuring 500 sq. yds. Regd. Doc. no. 9251 in book no.1 volume no. 0/11 page no. 13-15 SRO-Faridabad, and same to be financed by **ADITYA BIRLA HOUSING FINANCE LIMITED That,** Original Regd. Conveyance Deed Dated 22.09.1989 executed by HUDA in favour of Smt. Harvinder Jit Kaur in respect of said property. Regd. Doc. no. 10328 in book no. 1. **has been lost/or not available**, If any Person having any type of claim/right/title/interest over the said property, may inform in writing, at the address mentioned below, about his objections, within **7 days** from today, failing which it shall be presumed that the said property is free from all type of Encumbrances, lien etc.

Lucem Legal LLP
N-161, Ground Floor, Saira Tower, Gautam Nagar
Near Yusuf Sarai Community Centre,New Delhi-110049
Contact # 011-40046316 & 41667327

PUBLIC NOTICE

That my Client, Smt. Raksha Sharma, W/o Late Shri Om Prakash Sharma, R/o D- 109, First floor, Narwana Apartment, I.P. extension, Delhi, have disowned and severed all her relations, and association with her elder son Shri Gaurav Sharma, her daughter in law Smt. Priya Sharma, and her Grandson Lakshya Sharma, from 07.10.2026 with immediate effect due to extremely Bad behaviour and physical Injury caused upon my Client and they shall have no right, title, interest, claim or concern whatsoever in any of her movable or immovable properties, assets, investments, bank accounts or other belongings, whether presently owned or acquired by her in future.

Rajesh Kumar Sharma (Advocate),
G-303, Lawyers Chamber, Karkardooma Courts, Delhi -110032

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is to inform to the public at large that Mr. Tripat Kaur had acquired First Floor without roof rights built on Property bearing Municipal no. WZ-53, built on Plot no. G-32, G- Block, Gali no.19, Hari Nagar (Shiv Nagar), New Delhi, vide Sale Deed dt. 24.08.2000 executed by Mrs. Satnam Kaur. Original Sale Deed Dt.03.09.1955, document no. 592, GPA dt. 14.02.1996, document no. 5749 along with ATS and WILL, and GPA dt. 13.05.1998, document no. 27530 along with ATS and WILL are lost. Now Mrs. Tripat Kaur is the undisputed owner of above said property.

OR

Any person / firm / institution / company having any claim or right in respect of the said Property by way of inheritance, share, sale, agreement, lease, license, gift, possession, legal heirs, partners or encumbrance howsoever or otherwise is hereby required to intimate in writing to the undersigned within 07 days from the date of publication of this notice of his/her/their share or claim, if any, with all supporting documents at below mentioned address. After expiration of notice period, the claims, if any, of such person shall be treated null and void and also treated as waived and not binding on our client.

Ajay Kumar Giri (Advocate) H No. 26/161, Basement, Vikram Vihar, Lajpat Nagar 4, New Delhi -110024

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is to inform to the public at large that Mr. Sunny Tanwar had acquired Plot No. 30, area measuring 750 sq. yds., out of Khasra No. 516(0-15), situated in the extended abadi Lal Dora Chandan Hulla, Tehsil Mehrauli New Delhi vide Gift Deed dated 18.09.2026 executed by Mr. Jatan Singh, document no. 2026/75/I/359. Now Mr. Sunny Tanwar is the undisputed owner of above said property and willing to Mortgage the above said property with CIFCL.

OR

Any person / firm / institution / company having any claim or right in respect of the said Property by way of inheritance, share, sale, agreement, lease, license, gift, possession, legal heirs, partners or encumbrance howsoever or otherwise is hereby required to intimate in writing to the undersigned within 07 days from the date of publication of this notice of his/her/their share or claim, if any, with all supporting documents at below mentioned address. After expiration of notice period, the claims, if any, of such person shall be treated null and void and also treated as waived and not binding on our client.

Ajay Kumar Giri (Advocate) H No. 26/161, Basement, Vikram Vihar, Lajpat Nagar 4, New Delhi -110024

Public Notice

This is to inform the general public that Major Parali Venkatesharan Krishnan and Ms. Rama Muthuswamy Iyer are the Possessor of the Plot of land area measuring 770 Sq. yds., Plot No. A-18, area measuring 270 Sq. Yds., out of Khasra No. 249/1min and Plot bearing No. C, area measuring 500 Sq. Yds., out of Khasra No. 249/2min, situated in the revenue Estate of Village Chhattarpur, Tehsil Saket, now known as "Chhattarpur Enclave Phase-II", New Delhi. He is Possession through Regd. GPA, Notarized ATS & Will dated 21.10.2004 executed by Capt. Dilawar Singh Sangwan in favour of Major Parali Venkatesharan Krishnan and Ms. Rama Muthuswamy Iyer in respect of said plots.

Major Parali Venkatesharan Krishnan and Ms. Rama Muthuswamy Iyer intend to transfer the ownership of above said Plots by way of Sale Deed to M/S Lamaison Innovations & Design Private limited though its Director Ms. Jai Laxmi Bai. Subsequently, M/S Lamaison Innovations & Design Private limited though its Director Ms. Jai Laxmi Bai are in the process of mortgaging the said Plots with ICICI Home Finance Co. Limited. Any objections or concerns regarding this transaction should be raised within a period of 15 days from the date of this public notice. Any objections submitted after the completion of this 15-days period will not be considered binding with respect to the said property or the interests of our client.

If anyone wishes to raise an objection, please do so within the stipulated 15-days period by contacting Law Veritas: North (Advocates & Legal Consultants) at Office No. 11, 1st Floor, Building No. A-44/A, Sector-16, Noida, Uttar Pradesh-201301; Landline(s): +91012-04499711, e-mail: accounts@lvnorth.in

The Pioneer
CLASSIFIED

CHANGE OF NAME

I, Maya Devi, Mother of No.8037408N Hav Rajendra Kumar Jat, R/o- Dhani Garodiya Ki, PO- Raikaranpura, Teh- Kotputli, Dist- Jaipur, Rajasthan - 303105, have changed my name from Maya Devi to Maya Urf Panchi, vide affidavit dated 12/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Chandra Bati, Mother of No.16024265L Nk Hoti Singh, R/o- Vill+Post- Moroly, Teh- Deeg, Dist- Bharatpur, Rajasthan- 321203, have changed my name from Chandra Bati to Chandar, vide affidavit dated 12/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Moryashree, Mother of No.16017400L Hav Umakant, R/o- Vill- Nagladini, Post- Kusmara, Dist- Mainpuri, U.P.- 205304, have changed my name from Moryashree to Mauryshri, vide affidavit dated 12/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Om Bai, Mother of JC-472662M Sub Ramveer Singh Shekhawat, R/o- Vill- Syalu Kalan, Post- Ram Rikh Ki Dhani, Dist- Jhunjhunu, Rajasthan- 333026, have changed my name from Om Bai to Om Kanwar, vide affidavit dated 12/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Leela Dhar, Father of No.14859934M Hav Patel Sundeep Leeladhar, R/o- Vill & PO- Tigariya Chhota, Teh & Dist- Dewas, M.P- 455111, have changed my name from Leela Dhar to Leeladhar Patel, vide affidavit dated 12/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, No.8037408N Hav Rajendra Kumar Jat, R/o- Dhani Garodiya Ki, PO- Raikaranpura, Teh- Kotputli, Dist- Jaipur, Rajasthan- 303105 declare that in my service record my deceased Father's name is wrongly recorded as Mangala Ram Jat whereas his correct name is Mangal Ram Jat which may be amended accordingly.

I, Jayalakshmi Shamji, W/o No.15438917F NK/ORA Shamji Thankakuttan, R/o- Kaniyamparampil, Purakkad, PO- Ambalapuzha, Dist- Alappuzha, Kerala- 688561, have changed my name from Jayalakshmi Shamji to Jayalakshmi Jayalal, vide affidavit dated 12/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Bibi Tahira, Mother of JC-830026L Sub Quiful, R/o- Vill- Kali Sathan, PO- Kumari Pur, Teh- Manihari, Dist- Katihar, Bihar- 854103, have changed my name from Bibi Tahira to Bibi Tahera, vide affidavit dated 12/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Kaushar Jahan, W/o- JC-830026L Sub Quiful, R/o- Vill- Kali Sathan, PO- Kumari Pur, Teh- Manihari, Dist- Katihar, Bihar- 854103, have changed my name from Kaushar Jahan to Koushar Jahan, vide affidavit dated 12/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Faggu Gyar, Father of- No.17000404F Nk Dhanraj Gyar, R/o- Village- Palamau, Post- Chhikhlikala, Tahsil- Mohkhed, Dist- Chhindwara, M.P.- 480107, have changed my name & DOB from Faggu Gyar (DOB 11.12.1962) to Phaggu Gyar (DOB 01.01.1963), vide affidavit dated 24/06/2026 before SDM Chhindwara, M.P.

I, Narmada Bai, Mother of- No.17000404F Nk Dhanraj Gyar, R/o- Village- Palamau, Post- Chhikhlikala, Tahsil- Mohkhed, Dist- Chhindwara, M.P.- 480107, have changed my name & DOB from Narmada Bai (DOB 02.01.1975) to Narbad Bai Gyar (DOB 01.01.1968), vide affidavit dated 24/06/2026 before SDM Chhindwara, M.P.

I, Shalini Singh W/o Manoj Kumar Arya R/o Flat No. 201, Plot No. B-611, Vasant Kunj Enclave, B-Block, Vasant Kunj, New Delhi-110070 have changed my minor Daughter's name from Divyanshi Arya to Sarvani P Arya for all future purposes.

भारतीय विदेश व्यापार संस्थान
मानित विश्वविद्यालय
INDIAN INSTITUTE OF FOREIGN TRADE
(Deemed to be University)

Announces Admission to Full Time MBA 2027-29 Programmes

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2. MBA (Business Analytics) 2027-29 programme at Delhi Campus

Important Information:-

Admission through:	CAT 2026 score and other defined parameters as per selection criteria.
Reservations:	Reservation for SC/ST/PwD/OBC(NCL)/EWS are as per Govt. of India rules.
Dates of online applications:	From 12.10.2026 to 25.11.2026
Application Fee:	For MBA(IB) - Rs.3000/- (Rs.1500/- for SC/ST/PwD/Transgender) For MBA(BA) - Rs.2000/- (Rs.1000/- for SC/ST/PwD/Transgender)

IIFT will use the CAT 2026 score for short-listing/selecting the candidates for above Programme(s). IIMs have no role either in the selection process or in the conduct of the programme.

Other details such as eligibility, intake, selection criteria etc. are mentioned in the prospectus available on IIFT's website **www.iift.ac.in.** Interested candidates may apply online through the link available on IIFT website.

For any clarifications, please contact Ms. Meenakshi Saxena, Assistant Registrar or Admission Cell at 011-39147213/9773698083. Email: **mba_admission@iift.edu**

CBC 05103/11/0005/2627
Gaurav Gulati, Registrar

SMFG Grihashakti Nayi Asha. Naya Vishwas.
SMFG India Home Finance Co. Ltd.
Corporate Off. : 503 & 504, 5th Floor, G-Block, Inspire BKC, BKC Main Road, Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (E), Mumbai - 400051
Regd. Off. : Commerzone IT Park, Tower B, 1st Floor, No. 111, Mount Poonamallee Road, Porur, Chennai – 600116, TN

POSSESSION NOTICE FOR IMMOVABLE PROPERTY [(Appendix IV) Rule 8(1)]

WHEREAS the undersigned being the **Authorized Officer** of **SMFG India Home Finance Co. Ltd.** a Housing Finance Company [duly registered with National Housing Bank (Fully Owned by RBI)] (hereinafter referred to as "SMHFC") under Secuitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assests and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (54 of 2002), and in exercise of the powers conferred under Section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 issued Demand Notice dated mentioned below under Section 13(2) of the said Act calling upon you being the borrowers (names mentioned below) to repay the amount mentioned in the said notice and interest thereon **within 60 days** from the date of receipt of the said notice. The borrowers mentioned herein below having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the borrowers mentioned herein below and to the public in general that the undersigned has **Taken Possession** of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on me under sub-section (4) of Section 13 of the Act read with Rule 8 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002. The borrowers mentioned here in above in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with said property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of **"SMHFC"** for an amount as mentioned herein under and interest thereon.

Sl. No.	Name of the Borrower(s) / Guarantor(s) LAN	Description of Secured Assets (Immovable Property)	Demand Notice Date & Amount	Date of Possession
1.	**Lan :- 605439211738314** **1. Pankaj Kumar,** S/o. Shri Chand Singh **2. Jyoti Pankaj Kumar** S/o. Shri Chand Singh	Flat No Ugf.01 Upper Ground Floor Front Side Rhs Without Roof Total Area Measuring 322 Square Feet I.e 29.91 Square Meter Built On Plot No B-2s Khasra No 216 Situated In Rail Vihar Avas Samiti Ltd Hadbast Village Sadullabad Tehsil Loni Distt Ghaziabad **East-**Entry/Stairs, **West.** Rasta 2s Ft Wide, **North.** Plat No. Ugf 2, **South-** Plot No. B 26	17.06.2026 **Rs. 12,29,846.83 (Rs. Twelve Lakh TwentyNine Thousand Eight Hundred FortySix & Paise EightyThree Only) as on on 17.06.2026**	09.10.2026
2.	**Lan :- 613939211798246** **1. Mohd Atif** S/o. Bhurey Khan **2. Fatma Begum** W/o. Bhurey Khan	Second Floor Without Roof Rights A Part Of Bearing Built-Up Property No. A. 1/86 Old No. A-203 Bearing Built Up Floor Carpet Area 95.31 Mtrs 114 Sq Yards) In Part Of Khasra 934/125 Situated At In The Abadi Of Main Texla Road Kabir Nagar And In The Area Of Village Sikdarpur And Ilaqa Shahdra Delhi-110094 Boundaries:- **East-**Entry/Road 20 Ft Wide, **West-**Property Of Others, **North.** Property Of Others, **South.** Property Or Others	17.06.2026 **Rs. 52,77,523.68 (Rs. Fifty Lakh Seventy Seven Thousand Five Hundred Twenty & Paige Sixty Eight Only) as on on 17.06.2026**	07.10.2026
3.	**Lan :- 609139211285857 & 613939511767416** **1. Nisha Manu Dev** D/o. Manu Dev **2. Poonam Manu Dev** W/o. Manu Devi	Built Up Property Bearing Plot No.c-45 Second Floor Without Roof Rights Towards Left Side Area Measuring 73.25 Sq Yards 61.25 Sq Meater Out Of Khasra No. 336/ Situated In The Revenue Estate Of Village Bindapur Delhi State Area Abadi Konown As Colony Subhash Park Uttam Nagar New Delhi 110059	23.07.2026 **Rs. 27,06,690.07 (Rs. Twenty-Seven Lakh Six Thousand Six Hundred Ninety & Seven Paise only) as on 23.07.2026**	07.10.2026
4.	**Lan :- 620638011888764** **1. Rohit Pandey (Borrower) (Through Legal Heir Of Deceased Borrower) Shikha Dubey Ico-Borrower & Legal Heir) W/O Rohit Pandey** **2. Shikha Dubey (Co. borrower & Legal Heir).**	Property Area Measuring 5o Square Yards I.e 41.805 Square Meater Situated At Plot No 122 Aa Khasra No. 402 Block A Indrapuri Extn Colony Harbdast Village Gharoti Khurd Pargna And Tehsil Loni District Ghaziabad	17.06.2026 **Rs. 16,24,992.58 (Rs. Sixteen Twenty Four Thousand Nine Hundred Ninety TWO & Paise Fifty Eight)as on on 17.06.2026**	07.10.2026
5.	**Lan :- 609139212053364** **1. Raman Sharma** S/o. Bhawan Sharma **2. Kalpana Shrma** W/o. Raman Sharma	Entire Upper Ground Floor Without Roof/Terrace Rights Which Ia A Part Of Built Up Property Bearing 1800, Built On Land Area Measuring 7s Sq Yards For Say 62.71 Square Meater Portion Of Plot No.18 Out Of Khasra No. 524/315,535/315 Situated The Area Of Village Saleempur Mazra Maidpur Delhi State Delhi Abadi Known As Rani Bagh Shakur Basti Delhi 110034 **East.** Plot No. 1801, **West** Others Property, **North.** other Property, **South-** Gali 10 Feet Wide.	23.07.2026 **Rs. 40,47,718.72 (Rs. Forty Lakh Forty Seven Thousand Seven Hundred Eighteen & Paise Seventy Two) as on 23.07.2026**	09.10.2026

Place : Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh / Delhi
Date : 07.10.2026 / 09.10.2026
Sd/-
Authorized Officer,
SMFG INDIA HOME FINANCE CO. LTD.

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The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | TUESDAY | OCTOBER 13, 2026

Delhi traffic gridlock: Opposition march cripples city roads

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

Bumper-to-bumper traffic brought several stretches of central Delhi to a crawl on Monday, with commuters reporting hours-long delays as protests against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar intensified and Opposition parties held a march to the the Supreme Court.

Visuals from central Delhi showed long queues of vehicles moving at a snail's pace, with cars, buses and two-wheelers packed along major roads. Commuters struggled to navigate congested stretches as traffic piled up around key junctions, with several motorists taking to social media to complain about being stranded for hours.

In other visuals, vehicles were seen queued near Mandi House, Tilak Marg, Copernicus Marg, and the India Gate C-Hexagon, with traffic moving slowly as barricades and police personnel remained deployed in the area.

Traffic congestion was reported from several parts of central Delhi, including Mandi House, Barakhamba Road, Mathura Road, Ferozeshah Road, KG Marg, Ashoka Road, Bhagwan Das Road, Tilak Marg, Copernicus Marg, India Gate C-Hexagon, Rani Jhansi Road, Desh Bandhu Gupta Road, Connaught Place's inner circle, Minto Road, Asaf Ali Road, Akbar Road, ITO and Indraprastha Marg.

The traffic snarls came as opposition parties attempted to march towards the Supreme Court amid heavy police deployment and detentions.

Several social media users attributed the congestion to the ongoing protests, with commuters also flagging the impact of diversions. The congestion triggered widespread frustration among commuters, with several taking to social media to criticise traffic management and express concern over the inconvenience caused to city commuters.

"Delhi Traffic Police has downright failed. It is shameful for both police and political parties. People are suffering for hours in traffic for no reason," a social media user said.

"I have been stuck in traffic for two-and-a-half hours. What is going on in the city?" another user posted.

Other commuters said the congestion has disrupted their daily schedules, with some reporting difficulties reaching their destinations despite leaving well in advance.


Supporters at Barakhamba Road during 'March for Democracy' by INDIA bloc leaders to the Supreme Court, to file a petition against CEC Gyanesh Kumar and 'vote chori' in New Delhi on Monday PANKAJ KUMAR

Several users said the impact of traffic diversions was being felt beyond central Delhi, with vehicles being rerouted to alternative roads, adding to congestion on adjoining stretches. They urged authorities to manage diversions more effectively and provide timely updates to commuters.

The Delhi Traffic Police advised commuters to use Kasturba Gandhi Marg and Mathura Road as alternative routes to avoid Copernicus Marg and Tilak Marg, respectively.

In an earlier advisory, the traffic police had warned of possible restrictions and diversions at several major junctions and road stretches across the Capital in view of the ongoing protests.

The advisory listed Panchkuian and Mandi House roundabouts, Dr Dinesh Nandini Dalmia Chowk (W-Point), Ram Charan Aggarwal Chowk (A-Point), Minto Road, Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Marg, Guru Nanak Chowk and the Connaught Place outer circle-Barakhamba Road T-point among locations where diversions could be enforced.

Other identified stretches included Chelmsford Road near Connaught Place outer circle, Bharion Road-MGM Ring Road T-point, Lodhi Road flyover, Neela Gumbad roundabout, Sardar Patel Marg-Panchsheel Marg crossing, Bhikaji Cama Place and areas under the Moti Bagh flyover.

The advisory mentioned possible traffic restrictions at the Ring Road-San Martin Marg T-point, Ashoka Road-Jantar Mantar roundabout, Jai Singh Road-Sansad Marg crossing, Jai Singh Road-Ashoka Road T-point and at Patel Chowk, Rail Bhawan and RML Hospital roundabouts.

Police advised motorists to avoid non-essential travel through affected areas, follow diversion signs and instructions issued by traffic personnel, and allow additional time for their journeys. Commuters travelling to railway stations, interstate bus terminals and the airport through New Delhi and central Delhi were also advised to factor in sufficient extra travel time.

The traffic police said diversions would be implemented depending on the prevailing law-and-order situation and real-time ground conditions, and urged commuters to follow its social media channels for updates.

Jantar Mantar: End of an era for Delhi's heart of dissent

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

For several decades, Jantar Mantar has been synonymous with protests in the national Capital, a place where farmers, students, workers and political organisations have gathered to raise their demands. From Anna Hazare's hunger strike to the Nirbhaya protests and the agitation over the NEET paper leak, the site has witnessed powerful expressions of public dissent.

Ironically, Jantar Mantar's towering instruments, designed to track time and the movement of celestial bodies, have made it a place to gauge the times and the shifting tides of public sentiment. Now that Delhi Police has de-notified it as a designated protest site, the landmark risks losing its relevance as a space where people can make themselves heard.



However, Delhi's address for protests has not always been Jantar Mantar. Before it emerged as a prominent hub for demonstrations, the sprawling lawns around India Gate and the Boat Club, close to Parliament and the Government's principal offices, were among the capital's most important spaces for political mobilisation.

Protesters also camped behind the Red Fort for days on end, awaiting the seat of power to wake up to their demands. In October 1988, farmer leader Mahendra Singh Tikait led a massive gathering of farmers at the Boat Club lawns. Thousands of farmers, accompanied by their cattle, occupied the area for days, putting pressure on the then Rajiv Gandhi Government to address their demands.

The agitation brought the issue of who could protest, and where, into sharper focus. The scale of the gathering, its proximity to key government establishments and concerns over security and public order prompted authorities to reconsider the use of the Boat Club as a protest venue.

Restrictions on demonstrations followed, and by 1993, Jantar Mantar emerged as an alternative site. Jantar Mantar offered a location close enough to the seat of power for protesters to draw the attention of the Government, while being more manageable than the expansive Boat Club lawns.

The Supreme Court, in its July 2018 judgment in Mazdoor Kisan Shakti Sangathan vs Union of India, traced the changing locations of protests in Delhi, from Ramlila Maidan to the Boat Club, and eventually to Jantar Mantar.

It noted that police had shifted demonstrations from the Boat Club because they were obstructing traffic. Police designated Jantar Mantar for gatherings of up to 5,000 people, while larger demonstrations were to be held at Ramlila Maidan.

When the administration designated Jantar Mantar as the new official protest zone, the first demonstration was recorded there in 1993. This historic beginning was led by Ashish Sood, then president of the Delhi University Students' Union (DUSU). He, along with his comrades, launched the first protest on the Jantar Mantar road against an administrative decision and anti-student policies of the Central Government. Since that one student movement, the ground has become a permanent venue for raising voices against anti-people policies.

Comparing Delhi's three new protest sites: Scale and location

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

The three new sites designated for holding protests vary considerably in size and location, with Burari Ground offering much more space in North Delhi, while the CBD Ground is situated in a busy commercial area in East Delhi.

The three new sites that were designated for protest are CBD Ground, Ramlila Ground, and Burari Ground.

The CBD Ground, situated in a busy commercial area in Shahdara, is maintained by the Delhi Development Authority (DDA). Spread over 12 acres, it adjoins Vikas Marg, a vital arterial road in East Delhi that connects the Trans-Yamuna region to Central Delhi via ITO Bridge. The ground regularly hosts cultural events. However, its location in a densely developed commercial and residential neighbourhood has raised concerns about the potential impact of protests on nearby communities and businesses.

"There are commercial areas and residential spots around the CBD ground, two malls, a five-star hotel, and several banquets lined up inside the ground. In case protests are held here, there could be an impact on the


Ramlila Ground

colonies nearby; it could be a law and order problem in the area," BS Vohra, president of Federation of East Delhi Residents' Welfare Associations, said.

In North-West Delhi, the Burari Ground, popularly known as Nirankari ground, is the largest of the three designated sites. Spread over 50 acres, it is bounded by Dr KB Hegdewar Marg to the south/southwest and Shah Alam Band Marg to the north/northeast. It frequently hosts cultural events and political programmes.

SIR - 2026
DELHI
विशेष गहन पुनरीक्षण (Special Intensive Revision)
CHIEF ELECTORAL OFFICER, DELHI
Old St. Stephen's College Building, Kashmere Gate, Delhi-110006

"No eligible voter to be left out of Electoral Roll"- Campaign by CEO, Delhi

- House-to-house enumeration of electors conducted by Booth Level Officers (BLOs).
- Concurrent Audit of exercise done by Booth Level Agents (BLAs) of recognized political parties.
- ASDD list prepared and shared with BLAs.
- Accordingly, draft electoral roll consisting of **97,53,577** electors published.
- Around **33 lakh** entries in Delhi electoral roll was under logical discrepancies/Unmapped cases. By now, more than **20 lakh** cases have been resolved.
- Special Drive being conducted to cover all eligible voters.
- 13 District Election Officers, 70 Electoral Registration Officers, 902 Assistant Electoral Registration Officers, 1,313 BLO Supervisors and 14,947 Booth Level Officers are working to achieve the objective "**No eligible voter to be left out of electoral roll".**
- Within the stipulated time, rest of cases will be resolved and all eligible voters will be covered.
- Pro-active campaign will continue to achieve the objective "**No eligible voter to be left out of electoral roll".**
- Check your name in the draft electoral roll. File your claim or objection before 30th October 2026.

The claims and objections can be filed in following forms:

FORM-6
Application form for New Voters
Eligible voters whose name does not reflect in the electoral roll, please Fill Form-6 alongwith declaration Form

Form 7
For Objection for Proposed Inclusion/ Deletion of Name in Existing Electoral Roll

Form 8
Voter Application Form for shifting of Residence/Correction of Entries in Existing Electoral Roll/Replacement of EPIC/Marking of PwD.

Next Special Camps will be organized at all polling station locations on 18.10.2026 (Sunday) & 25.10.2026 (Sunday) to ensure "No eligible voter to be left out of electoral rolls" BLOs will be available to assist you

DIP/Shabdarth/Display/110/26-27

Download the App For more information
ECINET App
Voters.eci.gov.in
See Video for information
Contact Concerned District Election Help Desk
1950 Voter Helpline
Follow us: ceodelhioffice

Where Development Values Nature
DDA
AWAAS NIVESH YOJNA 2026
Sample flats available
25% Discount
Ready-to-move-in flats
First Come, First Serve Basis
Completely online scheme
Your Future Deserves A Smart Investment

2,516 flats available
in emerging sub city Narela
1-BHK FLATS (SECTOR G2-G6)

POCKET-3
Available flats 1020
Approximate Area 49.90 sq.m.
@ ₹ 15.01 lakh*

POCKET-6
Available flats 1496
Approximate Area 49.90 sq.m.
@ ₹ 14.95 lakh*

*(price after 25% discount)

REGISTRATION STARTS
14th October, 12 noon

BOOKING STARTS
20th October, 12 noon

KEY FEATURES • WHY NARELA

- Upcoming Sanoth Metro Station (Rithala–Narela–Kundli Metro Corridor), approximately 2 km away
- Proposed RRTS connectivity for faster travel
- Excellent road connectivity via UER-I (approx. 1.5 km), UER-II (approx. 4 km) and GT Karnal Road (approx. 5 km).
- Emerging education hub with land allotted to several universities
- Narela Sports Complex in Sector A-7. Proposed Multi-Sports Integrated Stadium and Sports Complex
- Planned residential environment with green spaces, open areas and civic amenities

For Booking & Registration, please visit: www.dda.gov.in or https://eservices.dda.org.in.

For assistance call at: 1800110332
Delhi Development Authority
Follow us on @ddaofficial @official_dda @official_dda_

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | TUESDAY | OCTOBER 13, 2026

Delhi Police warns of action against handle for fake claim of firing at Rahul rally

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

Delhi Police on Monday warned of strict legal action against a social media handle for a post allegedly spreading misinformation about police firing at a rally led by Congress leader Rahul Gandhi.

Delhi Police is monitoring various social media platforms to curb spread of misinformation in the wake of protests in the capital, with around 300 posts allegedly aimed at spreading rumours or creating public unrest taken down, police sources said.

The post in question claimed that Delhi Police had opened fire at Rahul Gandhi's rally, killing five workers, and urged people to come out on the streets and block Delhi, alleging that the situation was deteriorating and tensions were escalating.

In a post on X, Delhi Police said the handle @indiantiwari01 had a documented history of sharing doctored media, old footage and fabricated narratives to mislead the public. " Do not fall for or amplify this rumour," police said, adding that spreading malicious rumours on social media was a punishable offence and strict legal action would be initiated against the handle.

The action comes days after police arrested a 24-year-old man for allegedly using artificial intelligence (AI) tools to create and circulate a fabricated video depicting a police officer sexually harassing a woman journalist during a protest against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar.



Police and security personnel stand guard in New Delhi on Monday PTI

The accused, identified as Nadeem Ahmed, allegedly circulated the video falsely portraying a police personnel in an objectionable manner, police said.

The incident is being investigated separately from the allegations of sexual harassment levelled against police personnel by women journalists.

The police have also approached social media platform X seeking the removal of objectionable and allegedly misleading content linked to the protests, sources said.

The social media monitoring exercise is aimed at identifying fabricated content, misleading claims and posts that could potentially disturb public order, they added.

Police teams are scanning online platforms, while further action is being taken against content found to be spreading misinformation or attempting to incite unrest, sources said.

Forest dept denies Cheetah death reports under RTI, cites risk to foreign relations

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Bhopal

The Forest Department has refused to provide post-mortem reports of cheetahs that died at Kuno National Park, citing concerns that disclosure could adversely affect India's relations with foreign countries.

In response to an application filed under the Right to Information (RTI) Act, the department said Project Cheetah is a national project of the Government of India, implemented through international cooperation. The department said it has signed Memorandums of Understanding (MoUs) with foreign countries for the project, and disclosing the requested information could affect India's relations with them. The department



invoked Section 8(1)(a) of the RTI Act, 2005, to claim exemption from sharing the records.

The Kuno Divisional Forest Officer's office issued the reply on October 9, 2026. Activist Ajay Dubey, who filed the application, questioned the department's reasoning, asking how making post-mortem reports of dead cheetahs public could adversely affect India's foreign relations.

Dubey had submitted the RTI application on January 28, 2026, seeking information on four aspects of Project Cheetah. A key demand was for post-mortem reports and related records of cheetahs that had died in Madhya Pradesh from January 1, 2024, until the date of disclosure.

The matter had also gone through the first appeal process. Following an appellate order dated September 17, 2026, the office of the Additional Principal Chief Conservator of Forests (Wildlife) and Chief Wildlife Warden, Madhya Pradesh, Bhopal, sent a letter to the Kuno Divisional Forest Officer on September 18, directing necessary action. However, the department subsequently refused to provide the reports in its October 9 response.

Dubey also sought information on the conservation and management of cheetahs at Kuno National Park, Gandhi Sagar Wildlife Sanctuary, and Rani Durgavati Nauradehi Tiger Reserve. His application included records relating to foreign visits and correspondence with various government institutions.

Questioning the decision, Dubey said concerns over sensitive information about living cheetahs might be understandable. Still, he found it hard to see how post-mortem reports on dead animals could harm international relations.

DU plans hostels for over 30,000 students

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

Several hostel construction and redevelopment plans, designed to add accommodation for over 30,000 students, are set to be tabled before the University of Delhi's Executive Council on Tuesday.

The proposals include high-rise hostels at the Dhaka Complex, new accommodation at the proposed East and West campuses, redevelopment of existing facilities such as Jubilee Hall and the PG Men's Hostel, and dedicated accommodation for women and working women.

The agenda for the Executive Council's meeting, scheduled for Tuesday, states that the Finance Committee has recommended placing the projects and their detailed project reports before the council for approval. If



approved, the proposals will be sent to the respective ministries for sanction and funding under grants-in-aid, the agenda said.

The university has proposed two Y-shaped hostels at the Dhaka Complex, one each for girls and boys, with a capacity of 4,836 students each and an estimated cost of ₹1,130 crore per project.

Both projects are planned as 2-basement, ground-plus-31-storey structures with a built-up area of 154,640 square metres each.

The agenda also lists a ₹400-crore Nirbhaya Working Women Accommodation-I project at the Dhaka Complex, with capacity for 1,674 residents, and a separate women's accommodation project of the same capacity and estimated cost.

For the working women's project, the Ministry of Women and Child Development has committed ₹200 crore, while the remaining ₹200 crore is proposed to be sought from the Ministry of Education, according to the document.

Among the major redevelopment projects are a proposed new hostel in place of the Jubilee Hall Hostel, estimated to cost ₹1,225.59 crore and accommodate 3,800 students; a ₹637.06 crore hostel in place of the PG Men's Hostel for 2,337 students; and an International Student House estimated at ₹966.39 crore with capacity for 3,300 students.

A ₹1,050.91 crore proposal for Block I and Block II at the Dhaka Complex, adjoining the working women's accommodation, envisages housing for 3,800 students.

The proposed E, F and G Block undergraduate hostel at Dhaka Complex would accommodate 3,162 students at an estimated cost of ₹678 crore.

FROM PAGE - 1

SIR row: Rahul seeks interim stay from SC

The petition names the Election Commission of India (ECI), poll body chief Gyanesh Kumar and Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi as respondents. The petitioners must now address the "defects" for the top court to list the case for hearing.

The Public Interest Litigation (PIL) named 11 Opposition leaders as petitioners: Rahul Gandhi, Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge, Trinamool Congress leader Saugata Roy, Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav, RJD leader Tejashwi Prasad Yadav, Shiv Sena (UBT) leader Sanjay Raut, CPI(M) leader MA Baby, CPI leader D Raja, Jharkhand Mukti Morcha leader Mahua Majhi, NCP-SCP leader Supriya Sule and IUML leader ET Mohammed Basheer. The case has been titled "Rahul Gandhi vs Election Commission of India." Since Rahul Gandhi could not reach the Supreme Court before the 4:30 pm deadline, lawyer S Prasanna filed the petition. The Supreme Court's registry has been directed to process the petition today. It also ordered the registry to rectify any defects so the matter can be listed for hearing on Tuesday. A bench led by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant will likely hear Gandhi's petition on Tuesday.

The petitioners urged the top court to direct the ECI to place on record the complete files, agendas, minutes, notings and objections recorded by the Election Commissioners in respect of each of the disputed decisions relating to the SIR of electoral rolls, together with the relevant ECINET and ERONET access logs.

It also contended that the complete file recording the decision dated 24 June 2025 to commence the SIR to enforce the rights under Article 14, 19, and 21 read with Article 324 of the Constitution should be placed on record.

The plea sought a direction to examine whether the disputed decisions relating to the SIR were taken in compliance with Article 324 of the Constitution, Section 18 of the Chief Election Commissioner and Other Election Commissioners (Appointment, Conditions of Service and Term of Office) Act, 2023, and the law declared by this Hon'ble Court in T.N. Seshan v. Union of India (1995), and, upon finding any decision to have been taken without lawful authority, quash and/or set aside such decision.

"Issue an appropriate writ, order or direction directing the competent authorities to take appropriate action against the persons responsible for any breach of the constitutional or statutory provisions governing the preparation and revision of electoral rolls, including under Section 32 of the Representation of the People Act, 1950, wherever warranted," it contended.

The petitioners also sought a direction to the poll panel, pending adjudication of the present petition and the connected matters, to ensure that every decision of the ECI relating to the SIR is taken and duly minuted in accordance with Section 18 of the 2023 Act.

"Issue an appropriate writ, order or direction directing Respondent No. 1 (ECI) to ensure that the online Form 6 conforms to the form prescribed under the Registration of Electors Rules, 1960, unless and until the said Rules are lawfully amended in accordance with the applicable procedure," it said.

The plea sought a direction to publish, boothwise, the names of all electors deleted during the SIR, along with the reasons for each deletion and a breakdown of deletions by gender and age, and to provide an effective and functional mechanism for restoring the names of electors found eligible for inclusion in the electoral rolls.

"Issue an appropriate writ, order or direction directing the Respondents to ensure that no elector is deleted from the electoral roll without notice and a reasonable opportunity of hearing in accordance with law, and to ensure that eligible persons in Punjab and other States going to the polls are permitted to seek inclusion in the electoral rolls until the last date permitted by law," said the plea.

The Opposition leaders sought an interim direction to suspend the ongoing SIR of electoral rolls across the States of the Union, pending consideration and adjudication of the issues raised in the present Petition, the protect the rights of eligible electors and preserve the integrity of the electoral process.

The Opposition leaders said they filed the plea seeking the intervention of the Apex Court in relation to the alleged unilateral and arbitrary exercise of the collective powers of the ECI by the CEC during the ongoing SIR of electoral rolls; the consequent concerns regarding the integrity of the electoral process; and the infringement of the constitutional right of eligible citizens to be registered as voters and to exercise their right to vote.

"The present Petition arises from serious allegations concerning the functioning of the ECI during the implementation of the SIR, including the alleged exercise of the Commission's collective powers by the CEC without the knowledge, approval or concurrence of the other Election Commissioners; the absence of a recorded decision of the Commission authorising the nationwide SIR; the unlawful modification of the statutory Form 6 without amendment of the applicable Rules; the centralised and opaque functioning of the ECINET and ERONET electoral-roll databases; and the large-scale exclusion of electors without adequate notice, hearing or an effective mechanism for restoration", said the plea. The Petition also raises concerns regarding the modification of the online Form 6 available on ECINET in July 2026 by the addition of a declaration concerning the presence of the applicant or their relatives in an earlier SIR electoral roll. The petitioners also sought examination of the manner in which the ECINET and ERONET electoral-roll databases are designed, configured and operated.

"The Petitioner submits that an internal review cannot substitute an independent audit of the electoral-roll databases, the access permissions governing them, the changes made to electoral records, and the safeguards available for reversing erroneous deletions. Reports concerning eligible electors who could not be restored to the electoral roll because the software allegedly lacked a rollback facility further underscore the need for an independent technical and procedural examination", said the plea.

"Pass such other or further order(s) as this Court may deem fit and proper in the facts and circumstances of the present case, to protect the integrity of the electoral process and the right of every eligible citizen to vote," said the plea.

Rahul Gandhi spreading chaos in India: BJP

Taking a swipe at Rahul Gandhi over his repeated allegations of " vote chori" , Thakur claimed that the Congress leader was challenging the people's mandate.

" Rahul Gandhi is a 'hawa hawai' leader. His entire style of politics follows the same pattern: 'hawa hawai' --hollow statements, baseless allegations, hollow actions, hollow protests and hollow facts," he alleged.

Thakur accused Rahul Gandhi of repeatedly shifting blame to different institutions, including the Election Commission of India (ECI), Electronic Voting Machines (EVMs) and the chief election commissioner.

" The situation has now deteriorated to the point where Rahul Gandhi is resorting to street-level language and making baseless allegations," he alleged. " Rahul ji, the country needs truth, not noise. It needs evidence, not allegations. It needs clear answers, not political statements," Thakur said. He also claimed that the President asked Rahul Gandhi to provide evidence with his complaint when he approached the President, but he remained silent.

The former Union minister further alleged that the Supreme Court had made it clear to Rahul Gandhi that he could not turn the court into a battleground for his politics. He also questioned Rahul Gandhi's approach to the judiciary in matters where cases are pending.

Ye mera mudda nahin hai: CJI

Asked about the opposition's march to the Supreme Court, the CJI said, " I will not make any comments on it."

" We will not allow SC to become a political battlefield, the CJI said, possibly reacting to the Opposition's decision to take out a march to SC. "Wherever designated places are, the protest can be held there in accordance with law," the CJI added further. Speaking to reporters, he added that any common citizen or elected representative could approach the court, and the court would hear their concerns and grant relief in accordance with the law.

Earlier, the CJI had declined a request from Lok Sabha leader of the opposition Rahul Gandhi and Rajya Sabha leader of the Opposition Mallikarjun Kharge for a meeting to discuss issues arising from the ongoing protests in Delhi.

In a letter dated October 11 to Mallikarjun Kharge and Rahul Gandhi, in response to their request for an appointment to discuss the protest against CEC Gyanesh Kumar, the CJI advised the two Opposition leaders to approach the Supreme Court through the judicial process rather than submit a memorandum on the administrative side. He also assured them that the court would hear any petition on the issues at the earliest opportunity, in accordance with the law. The request concerned allegations of irregularities involving the Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) and the Election Commission of India, alleged arbitrary arrests of students, the closure of metro stations and the cancellation of trains amid protests in the national Capital.

At the outset, the issues referred to hereinabove are already sub judice before the Supreme Court of India. Therefore, convening a meeting to discuss pending cases would wholly contravene the principle of Separation of Powers, an intrinsic facet of the basic structure doctrine of the Constitution of India, and would be incompatible with the established ethics and judicial propriety. " In this vein, I also wish to remind you that within our constitutional framework, the Supreme Court of India is not endowed with any administrative powers to deal with the issues highlighted in your letter," he said.

" However, in the exercise of our jurisdiction under Article 32 of our Constitution, along with other plenary powers, including that of judicial review, we are duty-bound to consider on the judicial side the gravamen of issues affecting the citizens of India," the CJI said, responding to Gandhi and Kharge's letter, which was shared by the Congress on Monday.

The Supreme Court of India reiterates its commitment to preserve and protect the Fundamental Rights of every citizen of India, and that they are entitled to seek enforcement of such rights at all hours through the procedure known in law, the CJI said.

Four killed in suspected LoC blast in J&K

Earlier, Indian Army troops on Monday detected two rusted landmines near the border fence in the Basoni area of Mendhar sector. The landmines were spotted during track construction at 8:25 a.m. and 12:10 pm, officials said, adding that Army experts later destroyed both explosive devices in a controlled explosion.

The Army detected and defused around a dozen landmines in the area over the past week.

Flags, placards and a wall of barricades

The route through central Delhi was anything but smooth. Police installed barricades at multiple points, with the main blockade on Bhagwan Das Road, directly along the approach to the Supreme Court. The layered barriers narrowed the available path and drew a hard physical line between the marchers and the court complex. Security personnel, including Rapid Action Force units and other paramilitary forces, held their ground in the area.

As the procession moved from the Connaught Place-Barakhamba Road junction toward Bhagwan Das Road, its forward momentum finally stopped. The marchers had set out to reach the Supreme Court itself, but police prevented the full crowd from advancing further.

Demonstrators gathered at the barricades as leaders weighed their next move.

At one point, Rahul Gandhi climbed atop a truck, joined by Akhilesh Yadav and Tejashwi Yadav, the three leaders rising above the sea of supporters below. The image offered a sharp visual contrast, political leadership elevated above the mass of the crowd it had summoned to the streets.

The police blockade ultimately became the day's defining feature. Three layers of barricading lined the approach to the court, backed by Delhi Police personnel and additional security forces. Similar security arrangements extended around Bengali Market and other nearby stretches, as part of a broader effort to contain the march before it reached its destination.

The crowd was not limited to party workers alone. Students and other citizens joined the mobilisation, while a contingent of lawyers reportedly carried copies of the Constitution through the procession, with groups of different affiliations converging around a shared demand for accountability from the Election Commission.

Even as the march stalled outside, the opposition's legal effort moved forward in parallel. A legal team filed a petition in the Supreme Court concerning Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, and a small delegation was granted access to the court premises to complete the filing, a quiet legal manoeuvre that proceeded even as the larger crowd remained locked outside the barricades.

By afternoon, the march had reached its physical limit at Bhagwan Das Road. The opposition's leaders and supporters had travelled the length of central Delhi together, only to find their path to the Supreme Court closed by a wall of police barriers, leaving the day split neatly in two: a procession stopped on the street, and a case quietly filed behind the cordon it could not cross.

JNU sacking, then FIR: Congress MP faces...

The university said it followed due process and that the findings meant his dismissal complied with the service rules.

The complaints were submitted in mid-May and spread after one student described an alleged incident during a viva in a private WhatsApp group; other students then came forward with similar accounts.

The inquiry revealed that the women reported being subjected to sexually suggestive comments in class and during exams. They said they were asked personal questions about their dating lives and relationships, experienced unwanted physical contact, and had viva interviews late at night at the professor's on-campus house. They also alleged that sexual advances were made at social events held there.

Some women students also mentioned that they had been offered better grades in return for sexual favours and that sexually explicit material had been shown without warning.

The situation has now gone beyond the campus boundaries. Student groups had previously protested delays in the university's procedure. On Monday, the BJP's women's wing marched towards the Congress headquarters, demanding that the party take action against one of its own MPs. Within JNU, some teaching staff members have questioned whether the Vice-Chancellor alone had the authority to order dismissal without first referring the matter to the Executive Council.

The incident has reignited debates at the university about classroom power, the influence of Internal Committees, and where academic life ends, and political ambition begins. For Congress, this means a current member of parliament from a sensitive state is facing both institutional and criminal investigations. Police have not made any arrests. What started as an internal disciplinary issue has now become a criminal investigation into alleged sexual harassment and insult to a woman's modesty. Both cases are still ongoing; Akoijam remains a Member of Parliament. His roles as a lawmaker and former academic now clash with the allegations, which he continues to deny.

Akoijam, elected to Parliament in 2024 from the Inner Manipur seat and known for raising Manipur issues, has firmly denied the accusations. He described the university's action as a political witch-hunt, questioned the inquiry's fairness, and said the public allegations do not match the Internal Committee's records. He also said he has nothing to hide.

Jantar Mantar out, three new protest sites in

While Ramlila Ground in Central District is four km from the current site, the CBD Ground in East District is 12 to 13 km away, and Burari Ground in North District is nearly 21 km away. The order denotifying Jantar Mantar as a designated site for protests was issued by Delhi Police Commissioner Anurag Kumar.

"Ministry of Home Affairs, Government of India, had constituted a committee to examine alternative proper venues for citizens' right to organise protest/demonstrations in place of the existing 'designated site'," the order read. Based on the committee's recommendations, it said, Jantar Mantar has been denotified as a protest venue.

Further, it said the committee will issue a detailed, revised SOP for organising protests and demonstrations at each of the three venues separately. This partially modifies earlier Standing Order No. L&O/48/22 dated 28.04.2022," the standing order issued by Delhi CP said.

The development came amid protests by the Opposition bloc INDIA and the satirical political group Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) in central Delhi against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar over the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) controversy.

Commenting on the development, CJP co-convener Saurav Das on Monday said the Government's decision to denotify Jantar Mantar as a protest site is "unacceptable", and they "do not accept this arbitrary decision".

In a statement, the New Delhi Traders Association (NDTA) welcomed the Centre's decision to de-notify Jantar Mantar as a designated protest site, saying the move would reduce inconvenience to the public and businesses in the national capital. The NDTA said designating Ramlila Maidan, Burari Ground and CBD Ground in east Delhi as alternative protest venues was a practical decision that would benefit the public and markets in New Delhi in the long run.

Rahul renews attack on CEC, alleges 200 Govt officials in touch with Opposition

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi


LoP in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi addresses a press conference at AICC headquarters in New Delhi on Monday PTI

Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi made a series of sensational claims at a Press conference in the national Capital on Monday, reiterating his demand that CEC Gyanesh Kumar resign.

From claiming that 200 Government officials were in touch with the Opposition group, the Congress MP sharpened his attack on the Centre. Before the march, Rahul asked Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar to resign and become an approver, claiming he is not the "main vote-theft criminal".

He added that they are after the people behind Kumar's actions and that the Opposition might even forgive him. Rahul said the protests against Kumar will continue and the deployment of heavy security forces and crackdown on protesters proves how the Government is trying to protect him.

"Resign, turn approver; you (Kumar) have made a mistake, but you are not the mind behind the mistake. We know Gyanesh Kumar can't sleep at night; I am telling him directly, you will not survive as CEC," he said.

Noting earlier resistance that had not spilt over into street protests, the former Congress president said this fight will not stop and will continue even if it takes days or years.

Asserting that the Constitution is their religion, the Leader of Opposition in Lok Sabha said: "till the time the Constitution is upheld, the Election Commission does not go, and the election system is not revamped, the youth of the country are not going to stop."

"Five criminals will face justice. Five criminals have attacked the idea of India and attacked its soul. We will not budge or stop, no matter how much time it takes," he said. The opposition has been demanding the CEC's resignation after a report by The Indian Express said Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi objected on record at least 14 times over the last 10 months, mostly to decisions and orders related to the SIR of electoral rolls.

India to host first BIMSTEC Home Ministers' meeting in New Delhi on October 13

ASHOKE RAJ
New Delhi



India will host the first-ever BIMSTEC Home Ministers' Meeting in New Delhi on Tuesday, October 13, 2026, Union Home Minister Amit Shah announced on Monday. The meeting is expected to bring together home ministers and delegations from member countries to strengthen regional cooperation on security-related issues.

In a post on X, Shah said the meeting would reflect the member nations' shared commitment to addressing cross-border security challenges, including terrorism, organised crime, drug trafficking, radicalisation, human trafficking, illicit financial flows and cyber threats.

He welcomed the home ministers and representatives of BIMSTEC member states, describing the gathering as an important step towards improving coordination and building a safer and more secure region.

Shah said India remained committed to working with its regional partners through stronger cooperation to tackle common threats and promote collective security across the BIMSTEC region. Meanwhile, Bangladesh Home Minister Salahuddin Ahmed is expected to skip the inaugural meeting in New Delhi.

Dhaka will instead be represented by a delegation led by a senior bureaucrat, against the backdrop of strained relations between India and Bangladesh.

The meeting marks a significant development in security cooperation among countries belonging to the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation (BIMSTEC).

BIMSTEC comprises Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Myanmar, Nepal, Sri Lanka and Thailand. The regional grouping seeks to strengthen cooperation among its members across several areas, including security, connectivity, trade and economic development.

The inaugural Home Ministers' Meeting is expected to provide a platform for member countries to discuss shared security concerns and explore ways to improve coordination in responding to emerging transnational threats.

CBI files FIR against ex-SSB Assistant Commandant over alleged smuggling nexus on India-Nepal Border

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH
New Delhi



The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) has filed a case against a former Assistant Commandant of the Sashastra Seema Bal (SSB). He is accused of helping with large-scale cross-border smuggling, having connections with known smugglers, and gaining unexplained wealth while stationed along the India-Nepal border.

Authorities say the FIR was filed after allegations that the officer, who served with the 20th Battalion in Sitamarhi from March 2023 to January 2026, was involved in illegal activities across the border. The Bhangaha Border Outpost is named as the main site of these alleged actions.

The FIR says the officer formed a "nexus with notorious smugglers from Raxaul and other nearby places" to help move illegal goods.

In exchange, he reportedly received benefits from those involved. His time at the border matched a period when smuggling of items like gold, drugs, and consumer goods was common, due to the open India-Nepal border and easy movement at certain points.

Investigators have also found suspicious financial transactions linked to the officer and his family. The FIR mentions several bank accounts in their names with unusual activity, such as large cash deposits made through deposit machines.

The agency thinks these deposits are part of a pattern of assets that their known income cannot explain.

The CBI has used sections of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS) and the Prevention of Corruption Act in this case. The charges include alleged criminal conspiracy and misuse of official position for personal gain. Officials said they filed the FIR after an initial review of the evidence collected against the officer, who is no longer posted in Sitamarhi.

This case shows the ongoing challenge of keeping integrity among staff working on sensitive borders.

The SSB guards the India-Nepal and India-Bhutan borders, where there are no fences and old trade routes make illegal movement easier. Several cases involve local smugglers working with border staff, but successful prosecutions remain rare.

In this case, the CBI is looking at both the connections at Bhangaha and the pattern of cash deposits. They are trying to show a clear link between the alleged smuggling and the officer and his family's wealth.

Investigators think using cash deposit machines helped avoid handling large amounts of cash directly, while still putting unexplained money into the bank.

The CBI is expected to examine the entire financial trail, identify the smugglers named in the FIR, and determine exactly what goods may have passed through the border outpost while the officer was in charge.

ED files supplementary PMLA complaint against former treasurer of Chhattisgarh Congress in liquor scam

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH
New Delhi/Raipur



The Enforcement Directorate (ED) in Raipur has filed a supplementary prosecution complaint under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA), 2002, against Ramgopal Agrawal, former Treasurer of the Chhattisgarh Pradesh Congress Committee, as part of its liquor scam investigation.

The agency filed the complaint with the Special Court (PMLA) in Raipur on 9 October 2026 and, on 8 October, also issued a Provisional Attachment Order for two properties in Raipur worth ₹9.06 crore.

The ED arrested Agrawal on August 11, 2026, and he remains in judicial custody. This move is part of the agency's investigation into the big liquor scam in Chhattisgarh, which took place from 2019 to 2023.

The investigation was started as a result of a First Information Report (FIR) being filed by the Economic Offences Wing/Anti-Corruption Bureau (EOW/ACB) in Raipur, under various provisions of the Indian Penal Code and the Prevention of Corruption Act, 1988.

The FIR names several people, including Anil Tuteja, Anwar Dhebar, Arun Pati Tripathi, and former Excise Minister Kawasi Lakhma.

The ED says a liquor syndicate controlled the Excise Department and the Chhattisgarh State Marketing Corporation Ltd (CSMCL) during this time. The syndicate is accused of generating over ₹2,883 crore through several methods, including illegal commissions on country liquor, selling unaccounted liquor in Government shops with duplicate holograms, collecting annual commissions from distillers, and using the FL-10A licence system for foreign liquor.

Laxmi Narayan Bansal, also called Pappu Bansal, managed much of the syndicate's cash and sent it to Rajiv Bhawan, the Chhattisgarh Pradesh Congress Committee office in Shankar Nagar, Raipur.

These deliveries followed Ramgopal Agrawal's instructions. People linked to the syndicate carried the cash and handed it to Devendra Dadsena, an accountant who worked for Agrawal.

The ED estimates that about ₹860-880 crore connected to the liquor scam moved through this channel. Of this, around ₹ 72 crore stayed under Agrawal's control and was kept, used, or distributed as he directed.

The agency says digital records, call details, and statements under Section 50 of the PMLA support the delivery process and Agrawal's involvement: Anupam Nagar and Katora Talab in Raipur. The ED has attached these as properties of equivalent value under the PMLA.



Editor's TAKE

Preparing for the D-day

Disasters are inevitable; devastation is not. The key lies in preparing for them before they hit and preventing them

Every year on October 13, the world observes the International Day for Disaster Risk Reduction, a reminder that disasters are not merely acts of nature but the outcome of human choices. Perhaps no country would need this reminder more than India. Nearly 59 per cent of its land is earthquake-prone, about 12 per cent flood-prone, and much of its long coastline faces cyclones and tsunamis, while droughts, landslides and glacial lake outbursts add to the list. Every year, hundreds of thousands of people are affected by the floods and torrential rains that lash its coastline, causing huge damage to life and property. The Odisha tragedy is still fresh in our minds. Nothing has been done to mitigate the disaster, yet we are still miles away from a viable solution that would provide a shield against such recurring disasters. The Disaster Management Act of 2005 created a national architecture, and the results show where preparedness is taken seriously. Odisha, which lost nearly 10,000 lives in the 1999 super cyclone, evacuated lakhs before Cyclone Fani in 2019. Early warning, drills and community trust save lives. But the approach is still crisis management, not averting disasters. It springs into action after a catastrophe, with relief packages, rather than before. Spending on mitigation is a fraction of what goes to response.

The deeper failures lie in governance. Building codes exist on paper but are poorly enforced. Several incidents related to fires in buildings and flooding of basements have occurred in Delhi itself. In the Himalayas, highways, tunnels, hydropower projects and tourist construction proceed without credible carrying-capacity studies; Joshimath's sinking homes and the Wayanad landslides are eye-openers. Yet our response is casual and cosmetic. Ecological advice is routinely set aside in the name of development. Local capacity is another gap. District authorities are understaffed, while panchayats and municipal bodies, the real first responders, are rarely trained or funded. Disaster insurance is scarce, leaving the poor to bear losses alone.

What should India do? That nothing can be done? Countries far more prone to disasters than India have done it. In Japan, earthquakes are frequent, yet no one dies. First, make mitigation, not relief, the largest budget priority, and tie development funding to risk assessments. Second, enforce building codes and retrofit schools, hospitals and bridges in high-risk zones. Officials must be held accountable. Third, map floodplains, landslide zones and fragile slopes, and make those maps legally binding for land-use approvals.

Fourth, empower local bodies with trained volunteers, funds and clear authority. Finally, restore mangroves, wetlands and forests as natural defences, and widen insurance cover. There is a way to do it; there are tools to do it; all we need is political will.

Digital sovereignty outweighs Musk's convenience

India's long-term digital resilience depends on supporting domestic entities that have true skin in the game. Domestic operations are bound directly by Indian law, answerable to local courts and invested in the nation's socio-economic stability



PRIYANKA CHATURVEDI



Elon Musk recently launched an offensive against India's regulatory pace over his company Starlink, a SatCom service not getting the licence to operate despite compliance with Indian authorities. Expressing his frustration over delayed commercial approvals, Musk accused "oligarchs" of keeping a monopolistic chokehold on the Indian market, going as far as calling the delays a "crime against the people". It was, to be honest, quite amusing to see a trillion dollars worth oligarch himself have a go at others, and a misplaced attack at that. While his ire was directed at the telecom companies that have partnered with him, his aim was to hit out at the Indian government. The government has rightly and firmly pushed back, saying that its regulatory framework is fair, transparent, and uniformly applied, and also confirmed that all major satellite communication licensees, including Starlink, Bharti Airtel-backed Eutelsat OneWeb, and Reliance Jio Satellite Communications, are currently at the exact same stage of security evaluation.

So why the tantrum? Does Elon believe that processes can be bypassed to accommodate him if he tries arm-twisting? It isn't how this works! In fact, there has been a long-standing concern about allowing Starlink permits to operate in India. As part of the Standing Committee of IT & Communications, I had repeatedly expressed concerns about the IT Ministry and Telecom Ministry's red-carpet welcome to Starlink. It took the Home Ministry to go through the checks and balances and rigorous procedures when dealing with strategic communication infrastructure, national security, and digital sovereignty. These issues must outrank the convenience of an impatient foreign corporation.

While Starlink presents itself as a simple broadband provider designed to bring high-speed internet to remote villages, beneath it lies a not-so-noble intent, because whatever price band that the SatCom is offering as per publicly available information makes it an expensive proposition. However, the concern is not merely pricing; the company is a vital asset for the American military and its intelligence apparatus. SpaceX holds highly classified contracts with US intelligence agencies to build robust spy satellite networks. For a nation like India-where an entity is deeply intertwined with a foreign military apparatus to control vital communication nodes without exhaustive vetting-this is a proposition fraught with risks.

> OUR DOMESTIC SPACE ECOSYSTEM IS CURRENTLY UNDERGOING A VIBRANT EVOLUTION, DRIVEN BY PIONEERING PRIVATE LAUNCH FIRMS, SATELLITE START-UPS AND ISRO. FOREIGN SERVICE PROVIDERS ARE WELCOME TO COMPETE IN INDIA'S VAST MARKET, BUT THEY MUST DO SO BY BOWING TO THE LAWS OF THE LAND AND THE RULES OF ENGAGEMENT

The writer is a former Member of Parliament (Rajya Sabha) and currently heads Women Led Futures at ORF

Furthermore, the Ministry of Home Affairs and Indian intelligence agencies have also raised concerns over Starlink's terminal vulnerabilities. Reports that Starlink terminals were active inside Iran during intense civil unrest-bypassing local telecommunications authority and monitoring-served as a major warning sign for Indian policymakers. If a US-based provider can have its equipment smuggled across borders and activated without state sanction, India faces a legitimate risk of foreign satellite signals spilling into sensitive border zones, where insurgent groups or external bad actors could exploit unmonitored communication lines.

The most compelling argument for India's caution lies in Starlink's turbulent track record in active conflict zones, most notably Ukraine. In the early days of the Russia-Ukraine war, Musk was hailed for activating Starlink terminals to keep Ukrainian forces connected. However, the limits of relying on a whimsical, single-source foreign billionaire quickly became clear. Musk famously denied Ukraine's military request to extend Starlink coverage near Crimea to thwart a Russian naval attack, citing personal fears of escalating the war.

This arbitrary exercise of a geopolitical "kill switch" proves that SpaceX keeps ultimate control over where, when, and how its network functions, regardless of local sovereign needs. Furthermore, because Starlink's primary satellite repositories, operations, and technical commands are based in the United States, the US government holds immense regulatory and strategic leverage over the company. If India were to face a critical border escalation with a neighbour, it cannot afford to rely on an infrastructure provider that might shut down connectivity based on the commercial interests of its owner, or under geopolitical pressure from Washington.

India's rules demand that all user traffic must be routed exclusively through Indian gateways, data centres and core networks must sit within the country, and data cannot be decrypted or mirrored abroad. Furthermore, strict geo-fencing must prevent signal leakage across borders, and authorities must have real-time terminal tracking access to combat smuggling. If Starlink genuinely wants to serve the Indian market, it must patiently satisfy these rigorous security checks, rather than taking to social media to cry foul and bully regulators.

Finally, India's long-term digital resilience depends on supporting domestic entities that have true skin in the game. Domestic operations are bound directly by Indian law, answerable to local courts, and invested in the nation's socio-economic stability. Furthermore, tie-ins to local capability, such as the government's mandate to manufacture ground equipment domestically and integrate India's NavIC navigation system, will cultivate a robust private space industry alongside ISRO and IN-SPACe. India should welcome global competition to expand choices for its citizens, but it must not compromise sovereign control over the networks carrying its national data.

Our domestic space ecosystem is currently undergoing a vibrant evolution, driven by pioneering private launch firms, satellite start-ups, and ISRO. Foreign service providers are welcome to compete in India's vast market, but they must do so by bowing to the laws of the land and the rules of engagement. India is not up for colonisation ever again or for new-age tech colonisers to dictate their terms.

Children have spoken. Schools must now answer



NANDITA BHATIA

2ND OPINION



In early 2022, the Education Ministry asked 3.79 lakh schoolchildren how they were doing. Eighty-one per cent said studies, examinations and results made them anxious. Satisfaction with school and life fell sharply in Classes 9 to 12, when we ask the most of them.

This World Mental Health Day's theme is "Lived Experiences Heard: Real Voices, Real Change". India has the first half on record. The second half is where we must now move. The cost is visible. The National Crime Records Bureau recorded 14,488 student suicides in 2024, the highest in a decade. Many were in classrooms in their final weeks, among adults untrained to notice.

The deeper problem is conceptual: we have mistaken mental illness for mental health. Counsellor-only models treat distress as a clinical event. Most of it is not. Most children are not ill, only anxious, ashamed of their bodies, afraid of a result, and never given language for any of it. Refer them all and we medicalise adolescence while still missing those who need care. They need well-being taught like any other subject: naming an emotion, asking for help, recognising a strength in yourself. A trained teacher, a timetabled period, and no child forced to declare themselves struggling.

Institutions are finally moving. The Supreme Court issued binding student mental health guidelines in July 2025. CBSE made counsellors compulsory in January 2026. But that covers about 30,000 mostly private schools out of nearly 15 lakh. In government schools, fewer than one in ten offers any psychosocial support. The risk is answering a systemic problem with an administrative one.

The evidence is no longer thin. Weekly teacher-led sessions in Bihar's Kasturba Gandhi Balika Vidyalayas, residential schools for girls from Dalit, Adivasi and minority families, improved emotional resilience and wellbeing by roughly a quarter. It works because the teacher already knows the child and no adolescent must travel, pay or disclose. I think of Nirasha, a girl in Rohtas named for despair because her family had just lost a son. In a session on character strengths, she met the word jigyasa, curiosity, and recognised herself. She changed her name; her school corrected its records and helped update her Aadhaar. No one diagnosed her isolation. They gave her a voice. A real voice, a real change.

For every child to have this, wellbeing must be timetabled and funded, not appended: hours in teacher development, a budget line that survives a change of government. Students must be heard on a schedule, not once every few years, and the hearing must lead somewhere. Jharkhand has written six hours on mental health into its 50-hour teacher programme.

India will soon have its first school mental health policy. It will be judged not by its language but by its presence: whether, three years from now, a fourteen-year-old in a government school in Nalanda has an adult trained to listen and an hour a week for her inner life. We have heard them. This October, the question is whether we can change their experience.

The writer is Vice-President and Country Director of WorldBeing India

Daiv Vani

WISDOM FOR A MEANINGFUL LIFE

Strength That Waits Unseen

Strength does not vanish when it is hidden; sometimes it waits, protected, for the right time.

After twelve years in the forest, the Pandavas had to spend a thirteenth year in disguise, unrecognised by anyone. Before entering the kingdom of Virata, they wrapped their weapons, including Arjuna's great bow Gandiva, in cloth and hid them high in a shami tree on the edge of a burial ground, where people would be too afraid to look. For a year, these warriors lived in humble roles: Yudhishthira as a courtier, Bhima as a cook, Arjuna as a dance teacher, Draupadi as a maid. No one guessed who they were.

When the Kauravas attacked Virata's cattle, the moment arrived. Arjuna took down the weapons, worshipped them, and defeated the Kaurava army. Tradition links this day to Vijayadashami, and the shami tree is still worshipped for it.

Many of us pass through our own hidden years: a period of caregiving, a job below our ability, a long wait for an opportunity. It is easy to believe that our abilities have faded. They have not. They have been wrapped and kept safe, and what matters is whether we continue to look after them while we wait.

This Navaratri, pick one skill or ambition you have set aside, and give it a small, regular share of your attention, so that it is ready when its time comes.

–DAIV

PIC TALK



An artist puts the finishing touches on a Durga idol made entirely of matchsticks at his home on the outskirts of Agartala, Tripura.

PTI

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Strengthening democratic accountability

The Right to Information (RTI) Act, 2005, completes 21 years on October 12, 2026. This is an appropriate moment to assess its achievements and shortcomings. Enacted to promote transparency and accountability, the legislation has transformed the relationship between citizens and public authorities.

The Act empowers citizens to access government records, question decisions and expose corruption, strengthening transparency and democratic participation. However, delays, vacancies in Information Commissions, inadequate disclosure and threats to RTI activists undermine its effectiveness. Balancing public interest with personal data protection remains equally important. The anniversary should inspire renewed commitment to strengthening the Act. Information Commissions must function efficiently, statutory deadlines must be respected, and information seekers must receive adequate protection. Public authorities should also improve voluntary disclosure to reduce unnecessary applications.

RTI is not merely a mechanism for obtaining documents; it is an instrument of participatory democracy. Protecting its independence and effectiveness is essential to ensuring that transparency remains a cornerstone of accountable governance.

AC VINEETH KUMAR | KERALA

Modi's 25 Years: A governance reckoning

As the ruling establishment celebrates Prime Minister Narendra Modi completing 25 years in executive power, one is compelled to point out the grim realities citizens face, which have defined his quarter-century in public office and tested his model of governance. Longevity in high office cannot whitewash a political trajectory marked by deep social fractures, alleged authoritarian overreach and systemic failures. Modi's tenure as Gujarat Chief Minister began before the 2002 Gujarat riots, in which hundreds of Muslims were killed. Fourteen years later, the sudden announcement of demonetisation devastated ordinary households, disrupted livelihoods and battered the informal economy, raising questions about executive accountability. Manipur's ethnic violence has raised concerns over the government's response, while examination irregularities have fuelled student protests.

Meanwhile, demonstrations over the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls have raised questions about public confidence in democratic institutions. Completing 25 years in executive power is a significant milestone, but longevity alone cannot settle the debate over governance. Political leadership must ultimately be judged by its commitment to constitutional principles, institutional independence, social harmony and accountability to citizens.

RANGANATHAN SIVAKUMAR | CHENNAI

Indian killed in Riyadh attack

An Indian national was killed and at least 10 other Indians were injured in an attack on King Khalid International Airport in Riyadh, Saudi Arabia, which left more than 300 people injured. The attack, which took place on Saturday, October 10, was the latest in a series of strikes targeting the airport over the past week. Several people of different nationalities were among those killed in the incident.

The fatalities included Saudi, Bangladeshi, Indian and other foreign nationals. India condemned the attacks on Riyadh's King Khalid International Airport as "completely unacceptable", urging an immediate halt. It reaffirmed its support for Saudi Arabia's sovereignty and expressed hope for an early return to peace and normalcy. Saudi Arabia has blamed Yemen's Houthi rebels for the attack. The incident comes amid escalating hostilities involving Saudi Arabia and the Iran-backed group, which has reportedly targeted border areas, energy facilities and civilian infrastructure with drones and missiles in recent weeks.

The latest attack has raised further concerns about the safety of civilians and critical infrastructure in the Gulf region, as diplomatic efforts and security measures continue amid escalating regional tensions.

BHAGWAN THADANI | MUMBAI

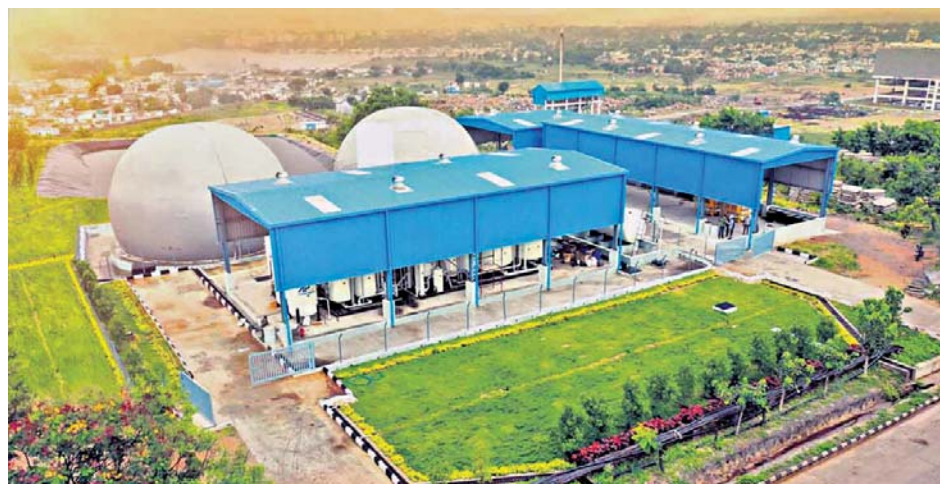
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Biogas: India's energy security and green transition advantage

India must therefore move from a plant-by-plant approach towards an integrated biomethane ecosystem. Farmers, cooperatives, municipalities, waste-management companies, entrepreneurs and industrial consumers need to be connected through commercially viable supply chains



SHISHIR PRIYADARSHI



REPRESENTATIONAL IMAGE

India's energy debate has rightly focused on expanding renewable electricity, diversifying energy sources and reducing dependence on imported fossil fuels. Yet one of our most promising domestic energy resources remains underappreciated: biogas. The opportunity lies in converting agricultural residues, animal dung, food waste and other organic material into usable energy, while recovering valuable nutrients and reducing the environmental costs of waste. As the World Biogas Association's India Congress convenes policymakers, investors and industry leaders in New Delhi on 8-9 October, it is an opportune moment to look beyond individual projects and recognise biogas for what it can become: an important instrument of India's national energy strategy. The question is no longer whether biogas has a role in India's future. It is whether we can build the markets, infrastructure and institutional arrangements necessary to realise its full potential. Five strategic considerations make the case compelling.

When we speak of India's energy security, our attention naturally turns to imported crude oil, natural gas and the geopolitical uncertainties surrounding international energy markets. But we should also look at the resources generated within our own borders every day. India's farms, livestock, food-processing industries and cities produce substantial quantities of organic material that can serve as feedstock for biogas production. After appropriate purification, biogas can be converted into biomethane, including compressed biogas (CBG), which can substitute for fossil natural gas in suitable applications.

Every unit of imported gas that can sustainably be replaced by domestically produced biomethane strengthens India's energy security, reduces exposure to international price volatility and improves resilience to supply disruptions. Biogas cannot eliminate our dependence on imported energy, nor should its potential be exaggerated. But it can contribute to a more diversified and resilient energy mix. We should begin thinking of biogas as a distributed domestic gas resource, one that can be developed across agricultural regions, industrial clusters and urban centres rather than concentrated in a handful of conventional producing areas. The strategic imperative is to assess how much of this resource can be mobilised economically and sustainably and then integrate it into national and state-level energy planning. Energy security is not simply about finding new sources of supply; it is also about making intelligent use of resources we already possess.

India's clean-energy transition is often discussed primarily in terms of electricity. Solar and wind power are transforming the generation landscape, and electrification will remain central to decarbonising transport, buildings and industry. But not every energy requirement can be met easily or economically through electricity alone. Some industrial processes require gaseous fuels or high-temperature heat, while other applications may benefit from renewable alternatives to conventional natural gas.

This is where biomethane can make a distinctive contribution. It can provide a renewable gaseous fuel for suitable industrial and commercial uses and, where technical standards and infrastructure permit, can make use of existing gas networks. It is also storable and can be supplied when needed, although production depends on feedstock availability and the reliable operation of individual plants. The point is not to pit biogas against solar, wind or other clean-energy technologies. It is to recognise that a successful transition requires a diverse portfolio of solutions. Renewable electricity and renewable gases can serve complementary roles in a decarbonising economy.

If the first phase of the transition has been about expanding clean electricity, the next must also address the fuels and industrial processes that electricity alone may not readily replace. Biogas deserves a place in that wider conversation. It can help connect renewable energy, agriculture and waste management in a way that few other technologies can.

Perhaps the most striking feature of biogas is that its raw material is already all around us, yet much of it remains underutilised. Agricultural residues, cattle dung, food-processing waste and segregated organic municipal waste can all contribute to biogas production, depending on their suitability, availability and the economics of collection.

We have traditionally thought of energy resources as something extracted from beneath the earth or harnessed from the sun and wind. Biogas invites us to think differently: energy can also be produced by organising the materials that flow through our everyday economic life.

But this opportunity will not be realised simply by announcing targets or constructing isolated plants. Organic waste is dispersed, seasonal and often expensive to collect and transport. Different feedstocks require different technologies, while plants need dependable supplies of raw material and reliable buyers for their output.

India must therefore move from a plant-by-plant approach towards an integrated biomethane ecosystem. Farmers, cooperatives, municipalities, waste-management companies, entrepreneurs and industrial consumers need to be connected through commercially viable supply chains. The objective should be to aggregate resources efficiently, reduce avoidable costs and ensure that plants operate consistently. The energy revolution waiting to be discovered is not simply in the waste itself. It lies in our ability to organise that waste into a reliable economic resource. India's challenge is to turn dispersed potential into dependable production.

The case for biogas extends beyond energy security and emissions reduction. It offers an opportunity to create a new economic relationship between agriculture and industry, in which farmers become participants in the renewable-energy economy.

Agricultural residues and animal waste can, under appropriate conditions, generate additional income. Biogas projects can create local employment and new business opportunities in feedstock aggregation, transportation, plant operations and equipment servicing. The digestate left after anaerobic digestion can also be processed into useful fertiliser products, allowing nutrients to return to agriculture when quality and safety requirements are met.

This creates the basis of a circular economy: materials that might otherwise be discarded become inputs for energy production, while nutrients can be recovered and returned to the soil. It can also help address some local waste-management challenges and reduce the open burning of agricultural residues where suitable collection and conversion systems are available.

However, these benefits will not flow automatically to rural communities. Farmers must receive fair prices for their feedstock, collection arrangements must be dependable, and the economics of projects must make sense for all participants. We must also ensure that the removal of agricultural residues does not compromise soil health or compete unnecessarily with other productive uses. If designed well, biogas can help diversify rural incomes while connecting agriculture more closely with India's energy and industrial ambitions. The farmer should not remain at the margins of the energy transition. The farmer should become one of its principal stakeholders.

The ultimate challenge is one of scale. India does not merely need more biogas plants; it needs a commercially viable biomethane industry capable of delivering reliable output over time.

That requires coordinated action across the entire value chain. Investors need predictable policies, credible assessments of feedstock availability, access to finance and confidence that the gas produced will find a market. Developers need long-term supply arrangements and dependable offtake agreements. Gas buyers need consistent quality and reliable delivery. Farmers and municipalities need efficient systems for collecting and supplying organic material. Without these connections, even technically sound projects can struggle commercially.

Policy must therefore move beyond capacity announcements towards actual performance. Support should encourage reliable production, efficient operations and demonstrable environmental benefits. Long-term purchasing arrangements, appropriate gas infrastructure, quality standards and innovative financing can help reduce risks and attract private investment. Public-private partnerships will be essential, but so will state-level strategies that reflect the distinct feedstock and market conditions of different regions.

The World Biogas Association's India Congress provides a valuable platform for bringing these stakeholders together and learning from international experience. The next step is to translate discussion into implementation: a clearer investment pipeline, stronger supply chains, bankable projects and measurable outcomes.

India should consider a coordinated national biomethane strategy that brings together energy security, waste management, agricultural development and climate objectives. The measure of success will not be how many plants are announced, but how much reliable, affordable and genuinely sustainable energy they deliver. India's energy future will not be built around a single technology. It will require a combination of conventional and renewable sources, greater efficiency, stronger domestic capabilities and a more resilient system for meeting the needs of a growing economy.

Biogas can contribute to that future in a distinctive way. It can turn organic waste into energy, help substitute for imported natural gas, create economic opportunities in rural areas and support a more circular approach to resource use. Its contribution will depend on realistic assessments of potential, sound project economics and consistent execution. It is not a substitute for every other energy source, but it is a resource we should no longer treat as peripheral.

The discussions taking place in New Delhi offer an opportunity to move the debate beyond the promise of biogas towards the practical task of building an industry. India has the raw materials, entrepreneurial capacity and growing demand to develop this sector, provided policy ambition is matched by commercial discipline and institutional coordination.

The writer is the President of the Chintan Research Foundation

The Great Indian Bustard and climate rights



SIDDHARTHA MISHRA | SHAZIA SIDDIQUI

The chronology of factors leading to the recognition of the right to climate change action in India fortuitously involves a critically endangered bustard, a bird, a solar boom and two Supreme Court benches that produced something surprising: India's first express constitutional right against the adverse effects of climate change.

In this regard, October 24, which falls this month and is commemorated as United Nations Day, also marks the International Day of Climate Action and is an apt date for raising a legal question: what promises does the Indian Constitution carry about the climate for Indians? Surprisingly, though, the answer begins with a bird, the Great Indian Bustard.

Evolution, which is oblivious to environmental impact assessments, gave the Great Indian Bustard eyes on the sides of its head, giving it wider peripheral vision in an open territory, handy for spotting predators. However, against a high-tension line, the same trait becomes problematic, as the bird has evolved to see predators around it, but that wide field of vision does not help it spot a thin power line in its path, and it gets injured by hitting against it.

In *MK Ranjitsinh v Union of India*, the Supreme Court initially intervened in April 2021 to protect the species, restricting certain overhead power lines across parts of Rajasthan and Gujarat. On March 21, 2024, the same litigation produced a landmark constitutional proposition: the right to be free from the adverse effects of climate change, grounded in Articles 14 and 21 of the Constitution. The Court recognised that climate change is not merely an environmental concern; it can also threaten constitutional rights. It described the right against climate harm and the right to a clean environment as "two sides of the same coin". Although Article 21 had long been interpreted to protect the environment, the judgment expressly located climate change within India's constitutional framework.



Though the right to climate protection surfaced in a case about a bird and energy projects, another test emerged in another case, brought by a child. In 2017, nine-year-old Ridhima Pandey of Uttarakhand asked the National Green Tribunal (NGT) to consider climate change in environmental impact assessments (EIA) and to make the government prepare a carbon budget. The Tribunal dismissed her petition in 2019, but she appealed to the Supreme Court.

The case became significant in 2025, when the Court called climate change an "existential predicament", said environmental laws must impose enforceable duties to address it, and sought from the Power Ministry a plan to reduce emissions from power generation. In simple terms, the Court was asking: what should the government actually do about climate change? The case is still pending, and notably, its orders do not expressly invoke the climate right recognised in the bustard case.

Meanwhile, the bird's own case moved on, and on December 19, 2025, the Court accepted the expert committee's revised plan, which identified certain areas of Rajasthan and Gujarat for special protection, as they are important habitats for the bustard. In these areas, new wind turbines and large solar plants are restricted, while about 250 km of critical power lines are to be moved underground within two years. Whether this will be enough to save the bustard remains to be seen.

The International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN) has classified the bustard as critically endangered since 2011. A 2020 study by the Wildlife Institute of India estimated that around 18 birds could die each year from collisions with transmission lines. Its population remains very low, with much of its natural habitat already lost or no longer used by the bird. In Kachchh, only a handful of wild birds remain. For a species so close to extinction, even a small change in its habitat can have serious consequences.

But the story is no longer only about the bustard; rather, it brings us back to the larger question with which we began: what does the Constitution actually promise Indians in the face of climate change? The answer is important and still developing. Though the Supreme Court has stated that people have a right to be protected from the adverse effects of climate change, it remains unclear what a person can ask the government to do when climate change seriously affects their life or livelihood, what government action or inaction can be challenged, or what relief a court can grant. The Court's reasoning also drew upon India's international climate commitments, including the Paris Agreement, and the work of UN human-rights bodies. These materials helped connect climate change with threats to basic human rights and India's constitutional guarantees of equality and life.

This is where Ridhima Pandey's case may become as important as the bustard case. While the latter gave constitutional recognition to the right against the adverse effects of climate change, Ridhima Pandey's case raises the harder question: what does that right require the State to do?

There is, therefore, an irony in the story. The Great Indian Bustard evolved for a landscape without wires, while Indian constitutional law evolved for a country without a declared climate emergency. A bird that could not see a power line has helped us see something that was largely invisible in constitutional law: the human consequences of climate change. Both the bird and the law are now improvising to survive a changed landscape — though only humans can take their case to court. The real test of this newly recognised right, and of the Court, will arise when a person approaches a court and says that a government decision, project or failure to act is exposing them to serious climate harm. Recognition of the right is only the beginning; the harder task is turning a constitutional promise into something that a person can actually claim and a government actually honours.

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Nana Patekar, the Soldier at heart who left us on Air Force Day



SAYAN CHATTERJEE

There are some coincidences in life that feel almost too symbolic to ignore. Nana Patekar, one of Indian cinema's most distinctive actors, died on October 8, 2026, at the age of 75 at his Goa residence, as reported. It feels as though a portion of myself has died today. October 8 is also the day India marks Air Force Day. This year, the Indian Air Force completed 94 years of service, remembering generations of air warriors who have guarded the country's skies since its establishment in 1932.

For an actor whose relationship with the armed forces went far beyond playing soldiers on screen, the date carries quiet poignancy. Nana Patekar was not simply an actor who understood the military because he had portrayed it. His relationship with the uniform became part of his own life. While preparing for his 1991 film *Prahaar: The Final Attack*, which he directed and starred in, Patekar underwent extensive training with the Maratha Light Infantry unit of the Indian Army. Accounts of his preparation describe years of military training and the development of strong shooting skills.

Then came 1999. India was fighting the Kargil conflict. For most people in public life, the natural response was to express solidarity, donate, speak about the troops or appear at patriotic events. Patekar wanted something different. He wanted to go closer to the soldiers, to serve the nation from the frontline.

He approached the then Defence Minister, the late George Fernandes, and sought special permission to accompany Army personnel. The request was not an ordinary one. An actor entering operational areas during an active conflict was obviously a matter of security and military protocol. Yet, Fernandes eventually granted special permission. Patekar subsequently spent time with troops in areas including Drass and along the Line of Control. Recent accounts of his recollections say he was associated with a Quick Reaction Team (QRT) and spent several weeks with Army personnel, while other accounts describe his duties in patrol and military hospital environments.

The important point is not to turn Patekar into a battlefield hero, which he never claimed to be. It is something more human. He wanted to understand the soldier beyond the costume, the dialogue and the cinema screen.

That distinction matters. Indian cinema has produced countless memorable military characters — from *Haqeeqat* and *Border* to *Lakshya*, *Uri* and *Sam Bahadur*. But Patekar's connection with the armed forces had an unusual quality. He did not merely borrow the language of military discipline for a role. He carried some of that discipline into his own life and eventually became associated with the Territorial Army, retiring as a Lieutenant Colonel in 2013.



His military association also needs to be seen against India's own history. The armed forces have repeatedly occupied that space between national security and national emotion. In 1947, the Indian Air Force played a critical role in transporting troops and equipment during the defence of Jammu and Kashmir. In 1965 and 1971, air power became central to India's wars. In Kargil, air operations once again demonstrated how technology, courage and human endurance meet under extreme conditions.

Perhaps that is why Patekar's military interest never appeared entirely ornamental. But there was another side to the man, away from cameras and uniforms. His social work was often quieter than his cinema.

He supported relief work after floods in Bihar, donated his remuneration from *Paathshaala* to charitable organisations and helped families of farmers in Maharashtra who were deeply affected by drought and debt. In 2015, he and actor Makarand Anaspure spearheaded the Naam Foundation, which works with drought-affected rural communities, farmers, water conservation and village development.

That work is significant because it reflected another idea of service. The soldier serves the nation in uniform. The citizen serves it through society. Patekar, in his own way, occupied both spaces. His artistic record was formidable. Three National Film Awards recognised his performances, including for *Parinda*, *Krantiveer* and *Agni Sakshi*. In 2013, the Government of India conferred on him the Padma Shri for his contribution to art and cinema.

Yet awards alone cannot explain why his passing feels different to me on this date. Perhaps it is because Patekar never quite fitted the conventional image of a Bollywood star to me. His voice could be theatrical, but his public persona often seemed deliberately stripped of glamour. His characters could be violent, vulnerable, angry, broken or patriotic. Behind them was an actor who appeared most comfortable when the performance had something real at its centre.

And so, on October 8, as Indian Air Force aircraft take to the skies and the nation remembers its air warriors, another farewell is taking place on the ground. The Indian Air Force marks 94 years of "Touch the Sky with Glory". Nana Patekar's life reminds us that service to the country does not always come from a cockpit, a battlefield or a government office.

Sometimes it comes from a film set, a village, a drought-hit farmer's home-or an actor asking a Defence Minister for permission to stand beside soldiers during a war. Nana Patekar played many roles. But perhaps his most enduring one was never scripted.

A soldier at heart, a citizen by conviction, an actor by profession-and, finally, a man remembered beyond the screen. This October 8, the guns may remain silent in his honour. The aircraft may fly overhead for another purpose. But somewhere between the roar of an Air Force fighter and the silence of a final farewell lies a fitting last tribute to Nana Patekar. A last tribute, then, not merely to the actor, but to the man who believed that patriotism was something to be lived, not simply performed. I wish to have met him once in this lifetime. A regret to linger on.

The writer is an educationist and senior columnist

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The Pioneer

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Asian Games 2026 and the missed medal of long jumper Shaili Singh



GYANENDER SINGH RANA

India's performance was a matter of pride in the recently concluded Asian Games in Ngoyo, Japan. India finished at an impressive 4th position in the medals tally with Athletics being one of the main contributors of medals.

Women's Long Jump was in limelight after Shaili Singh was declared 4th in the event. The Indian contingent believed her jump distance was measured incorrectly, and the correct distance would have earned her a podium finish. India lodged an official protest with the on-site Jury of Appeals of the event. However, India's protest was turned down, thereby keeping Shaili at the 4th position for now. Subsequently, the Athletics Federation of India (AFI) has filed an appeal in front of CAS, Switzerland.

The appeal to the Court of Arbitration for Sport (CAS) was initiated by the Athletics Federation of India (AFI)-with backing from India's sports administration-concerning a highly controversial measurement of long jumper Shaili Singh's fourth attempt at the 2026 Asian Games. The decision to approach CAS came after an on-site protest by the Indian team was rejected by the event's jury of appeal.

What is CAS, Switzerland

The Court of Arbitration of Sport (CAS), Lausanne, Switzerland is the supreme body in the world for sports related disputes. CAS was established in 1984 and it focuses on arbitration and mediation to resolve sports disputes that are brought before it from any part of the world. The Jurisdiction of CAS includes global sports, resolving contract disputes, disciplinary issues, disputes in Olympic sports, and anti-doping matters. All CAS proceedings are governed under Swiss Law and final decisions given by CAS can only be appealed to the Federal Supreme Court of Switzerland.

There are 2 main tracks in CAS — Ordinary Arbitration division, Appeals Arbitration Division. The first handles first-instance commercial or contractual sports disputes. Appeals Arbitration Division, on the other hand, reviews decisions previously handed down by individual sports federations and governing bodies, once all internal remedies have been exhausted.



The Core of the Controversy

During the women's long jump final, Shaili Singh finished in fourth place with an official best mark of 6.42m. However, the primary point of conflict is her fourth jump, which visually appeared to clear 6.50 meters-a distance that could have put her in contention for a medal.

Instead, officials recorded the jump at just 6.41 meters. They justified this shorter measurement by claiming that Shaili's hair touched the sand behind her primary body landing position. Under World Athletics rules, a jump is measured from the take-off line to the very first break made in the sand by any part of the athlete's body or anything attached to them (including hair)

Grounds for the CAS Appeal

The AFI is challenging the decision based on how the rules were implemented and a lack of procedural transparency:

"Official Overruling: The Indian camp alleges that the official closest to the landing pit had initially pointed to Shaili's leg mark to measure the jump. However, an official standing much farther away intervened and insisted on measuring from a shorter mark. AFI argues the measurement should have relied on the official with the best line of sight.

" Withheld Video Evidence: When India immediately lodged a protest, officials only showed them a front-view video. The Indian camp argued a front view makes it impossible to judge the exact point of contact and demanded side-view footage. Officials initially claimed they did not have a side-view angle.

"Contradictory Jury Verdict: The Indian team took the case to the tournament jury. The jury ultimately dismissed the appeal, asserting they had looked at the side-view video and found the original measurement correct. The AFI finds this sequence of events highly suspect and structurally unjust.

What happens next

Because the Games' operational timeline has concluded, this case moves past the temporary emergency "ad hoc" track and enters the formal Appeals Arbitration Division procedures. The legal roadmap for Shaili Singh's case involves several distinct next steps:

1. Filing the Formal Statement of Appeal
2. Submission of the Evidence Dossier (Appeal Brief)
3. Constitution of the Panel and Response from Respondents
4. The Hearing Phase
5. Final Deliberation and Arbitral Award

Upon completion of the steps delineated above, the CAS panel will deliberate and issue a legally binding Arbitral Award. Under Swiss law (which governs CAS), the panel holds the authority to:

" Dismiss the appeal if they find the evidence supporting the hair-contact rule to be conclusive.

" Uphold the appeal if they determine that procedural injustice or structural error took place. If upheld, CAS can order the official results to be amended, which could retroactively alter the final long jump standings and alter medal allocations.

The road forward for India at CAS

India's approach to CAS arbitration is currently on case-to-case basis. As and when the need to file cases at CAS arises, a team of lawyers is put together. However, given that fact that India is turning into a sports powerhouse, sports disputes in international arena involving Indian sportspersons are only bound to increase. Hence, India needs to have an official panel of Lawyers that specialise in CAS cases. This would not only secure justice for Indian sportspersons, but would also ensure that the country is not robbed of its sporting glory as and when such disputes arise in the future.

The writer is an Arbitrator & an Advocate in the Delhi High court

Order Order

Delhi HC refuses relief to PepsiCo over energy drink label



The Delhi High Court on Monday refused to immediately interfere with an order denying PepsiCo permission to continue manufacturing products with the "energy drink" label.

Dealing with an appeal filed by PepsiCo against an October 6 order of a single-judge bench, a bench of Acting Chief Justice Nitin Wasudeo Sambre and Justice Sanjay Sharma noted the absence of "specific reasons" in the order and asked the single judge to record the same within a week to enable it to deal with the issue.

PepsiCo's senior counsel argued that despite protecting the company from coercive action over the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India's (FSSAI) directive to drop the descriptor "energy drink" from its beverages and allowing it to sell its existing stock, "Sting Energy" and "Adrenaline Rush", the single judge refused to allow further manufacturing with the label. (*PTI*)

SC orders SIT probe into alleged assault on lawyers



The Supreme Court on Monday directed the Delhi police commissioner to ensure that a complaint filed by a group of lawyers, who were allegedly assaulted during a protest to demand the resignation of Bar Council of India (BCI) chairman Manan Kumar Mishra, is investigated. A bench of Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana said a special investigation team (SIT) headed by a senior police officer be constituted for probing the complaint.

It said that after conducting the investigation, the police would submit a report before the jurisdictional magistrate. The top court passed the order while hearing a plea challenging a September 21 verdict of the Delhi High Court. The high court had dismissed a plea by a group of lawyers seeking a probe by the CBI or any other independent agency into the alleged assault, saying it was not maintainable.

The petitioners before the high court had sought an investigation into the alleged assault on them and other advocates inside and outside the premises of the BCI on the intervening night of August 20-21. (*PTI*)

Delhi HC agrees to hear plea against closure of Jantar Mantar as protest site

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



The Delhi High Court agreed to hear on Tuesday a petition regarding the alleged closure of Jantar Mantar as a protest site in the Capital.

A lawyer mentioned the matter before a bench of Acting Chief Justice Nitin Wasudeo Sambre and Justice Sanjay Sharma on Monday, stating that peaceful protests were being quelled as authorities had not earmarked an alternative site for them.

The court also agreed to hear on Tuesday another petition alleging that "outsiders" had entered the protest held over the weekend and harassed the protesters.

National Students' Union of India president Vinod Jakhar's petition sought a "fair, independent and time-bound probe into a series of assaults committed in broad daylight" on October 10 on ordinary protesters. When the counsel urged the bench to urgently hear the petition regarding the protest site on Monday, the court observed that the issue was also being looked into by the Supreme Court.

"The Supreme Court is equally seized of the matter. Not only that, but the Supreme Court has called on the Union to file their affidavits also. Once the Supreme Court is seized of it, we have to see — to what extent we can look at it again. That's why let us have it tomorrow," the bench responded.

The lawyer mentioning the matter told the bench that the "right to free speech has been quelled to a great extent and that has enormous impact".

"Now today Jantar Mantar is also closed. There is no other place which has been earmarked by the executive to actually carry out a protest in accordance with law. Peaceful protests are being quelled today. This is absolutely going to be a black day. We have faced this in 1975," the lawyer said.

Hundreds took to the streets on October 10 and 11 after the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) called a protest against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar over alleged irregularities in the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls.



No adjudication on new Form 6 while hearing Bihar SIR matter: SC

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Monday said it has neither approved nor disapproved the new Form 6 and this issue was not adjudicated upon while hearing the matter concerning Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in Bihar.

Form 6 is an application through which an eligible person seeks inclusion in the electoral roll.

The observation came from a bench of Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana that was hearing a petition concerning the SIR. The counsel appearing for the petitioner argued that the Election Commission had said that Form 6 was approved by the apex court.

He said the apex court had on October 5 observed that it had not approved any modifications to Form 6, which is being used by the Election Commission during the SIR of electoral rolls in various states.

"There is no adjudication on the new Form 6. That is all we have said," Justice Bagchi observed, adding that when the matter relating to the SIR in Bihar was heard by it, the issue of new Form 6 was not there. "What the Chief Justice said was that when the Bihar SIR matter was heard by us, the new Form 6 was not there," Justice Bagchi said, adding that this does not mean it was either approved or disapproved by the top court.

The bench said the plea would be heard along with similar pending petitions relating to SIR which are slated to come up for hearing on October 27.

While hearing a separate plea on October 5, the apex court said it had not approved any modifications to Form 6.

The Election Commission had issued a press release on September 26 suggesting that the apex court had upheld the Form 6 declaration in the May 2026 judgment relating to the Bihar SIR.

Cauvery issue: Hard to meet Tamil Nadu's demand, Karnataka to SC

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



The Karnataka Government told the Supreme Court on Monday that it will be difficult to meet Tamil Nadu's demand for the release of 11 thousand million cubic (TMC) feet of Cauvery river water for making good a "shortfall" as this was a rain-deficit year and several areas have been declared drought-affected.

On the other hand, the Tamil Nadu Government said it is only seeking its legitimate pro-rata share in the flows realised during the distress period, together with the backlog due to it, and the entire burden of meteorological and hydrological distress cannot be passed on to the lower riparian state, while Karnataka continues to utilise the available storage and inflows for irrigation and other requirements.

A bench of Justices Vikram Nath and Aapresh Kumar Singh reserved its decision on a fresh application of the Tamil Nadu Government, seeking directions to Karnataka to make sure that the backlog of 11 TMC of Cauvery water as on October 7 is cleared immediately and ensure the same at the rate of 1.3 TMC per day in 10 days at Billigundulu, a key water-measuring station on the banks of the river along the Karnataka-Tamil Nadu border.

Senior advocate Shyam Divan, appearing in the court for the Karnataka Government, told the bench that this has been a very difficult year and several areas have been declared drought-hit. "We have to ensure conservation of water so that the drinking water supply in residential areas is not affected," he said.

Divan further said Tamil Nadu has the benefit of the northeast monsoon in November, when its reservoirs will be replenished, while it will not help Karnataka.

"Every distress year, this has been the problem," he said, adding that there has been proper application of mind by the Cauvery Water Management Authority (CWMA) at its 59th meeting held on October 8, in which it directed Karnataka to release 3,000 cusecs of Cauvery water at Billigundulu from October 9 for the next 15 days.

Senior advocate Mukul Rohatgi, appearing in the court for the Tamil Nadu Government, said Karnataka be directed to release the shortfall on a pro-rata basis, else crops in Tamil Nadu will be affected this year.

The bench asked how can the backlog of water be cleared when there was scarcity of rainfall this year and both the States were affected.

Pinarayi Vijayan, daughter move Kerala HC against order to register FIR

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Kochi



Leader of Opposition in the Keralam Assembly Pinarayi Vijayan and his daughter Veena T on Monday moved the Kerala High Court against a single-judge direction to register FIRs against them in connection with the alleged CMRL bribery case.

In their appeals, they have contended that the single judge's October 9 direction was issued without hearing them.

Advocate P Narayana, appearing for Vijayan and Veena, said the matter is likely to be heard by the High Court during the day.

The appeals have been filed even as the Vigilance and Anti-Corruption Bureau's (VACB) Special Investigation Unit-1, on Monday registered two FIRs against former Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan and his family members in connection with the alleged CMRL bribery case.

The Kerala High Court had on October 9 directed registration of a case based on a report submitted by the Enforcement Directorate (ED) to the State police.

The ED had sought registration of a case based on evidence gathered during its investigation and searches conducted under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act.

2020 riots: Delhi HC seeks police stand on Natasha Narwal's UK travel

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi





The Delhi High Court on Monday sought the city police's stand on a plea by activist Natasha Narwal, who is out on bail in cases arising from the 2020 northeast Delhi riots, seeking permission to travel to the United Kingdom for an academic conference.

Justice Amit Bansal issued notice on Narwal's petition challenging a trial court order refusing her the relief in the case registered under the anti-terror law UAPA and listed the matter for hearing on October 15.

Narwal's lawyer said she intended to travel to the United Kingdom for a conference between November 2 and December 1. Her counsel sought an expeditious decision on the plea, stating that she had to apply for a visa after the release of her passport, which was earlier surrendered in view of the criminal proceedings, and also buy tickets.

On October 6, the trial court had refused to permit Narwal to travel to the UK in view of the seriousness of the case against her and the stage of proceedings.

Narwal was named as an accused by Delhi Police in three FIRs registered in connection with the protest during the violence in northeast Delhi in 2020, including the 'larger conspiracy' case under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA).

Communal clashes broke out in northeast Delhi on February 24, 2020, after violence between citizenship law supporters and protesters spiralled out of control, leaving at least 53 people dead and around 700 injured.

Narwal, Sharjeel Imam, Khalid Saifi, Umar Khalid and others have been accused of being the "masterminds" behind the violence that took place at a time when US President Donald Trump and other dignitaries were in the national Capital. In June 2021, the high court had granted bail to Narwal and Devangana Kalita in the UAPA case, observing that "in an anxiety to suppress dissent, the state has blurred the line between right to protest and terrorist activity" and if such a mindset gains traction, it would be a "sad day for democracy".

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | TUESDAY | OCTOBER 13, 2026

Puja performed for Dharavi rehabilitation homes

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Mumbai



(L to R): ANDPL CEO Anil Sardana, DRP/SRA CEO Dr Mahendra Kalyankar, Adani Enterprises Limited (AEL) Director Pranav Adani, Additional Chief Secretary, Urban Development Department, Government of Maharashtra, Aseem Kumar Gupta and Adani Realty CEO Jackbastian Nazareth on the occasion of *bhoomi poojan* to mark the start of rehabilitation construction, at Matunga Railway Land in Mumbai on Monday PIONEER PHOTO

Pranav Adani, Director, Adani Enterprises Limited (AEL), performed *bhoomi poojan* at the 22-acre Matunga railway site on Monday, marking the start of rehabilitation construction for Dharavi, one of Asia's largest informal settlements and home to more than one million residents. Adani Navbharat Developers Private Limited (ANDPL), the project's Special Purpose Vehicle (SPV), will ensure eligible residents will receive 350 sq ft homes under the in-situ rehabilitation scheme.

"Every family deserves a home where they feel secure and can plan for the future. We know what this means to Dharavi's families. At Matunga, we are building 10 towers with 10,432 homes and 1,379 commercial and industrial units, creating neighbourhoods where families can live better and build a brighter future for their children," said Pranav Adani.

The project draws on expertise in design, engineering and urban planning from US-based design firm Sasaki, UK-based engineering consultancy Buro Happold, Mumbai-based StudioPOD, renowned architect Hafeez Contractor, P&T and ARC Studio, along with urban planning experts from Singapore.

The 10 towers will be handed over in three phases to the Dharavi Redevelopment Project/Slum Rehabilitation Authority (DRP/SRA), under the Government of Maharashtra: the first five by March 2029, the next two by August 2029 and the remaining three by August 2030.

Aseem Kumar Gupta, Additional Chief Secretary, Urban Development Department, Government of Maharashtra, was the Guest of Honour. Dr Mahendra Kalyankar, Chief Executive Officer (CEO), DRP/SRA, also attended the ceremony.

Dr Kalyankar said, "This is an important step for Dharavi's families. Our focus is on providing safe, modern homes with the infrastructure and amenities needed for a better quality of life."

Each tower will have 37 to 39 storeys, 10 to 12 passenger elevators and two dedicated fire elevators. Two additional elevators will serve the commercial and industrial units. Amenities will include a kindergarten, community hall, podium gardens, sit-out areas, society offices and places of worship.

Ten per cent of the commercial space in each rehabilitation building will be reserved to generate revenue for common infrastructure upkeep. ANDPL will maintain the buildings and shared infrastructure for the first 10 years after handover.

The *bhoomi poojan* followed the inauguration of the Dharavi Experience Centre by the Chief Minister of Maharashtra, Devendra Fadnavis, on Gandhi Jayanti, marking Mahatma Gandhi's 157th birth anniversary. At the event, CM Fadnavis also unveiled an anthem dedicated to Dharavi and released a coffee-table book on its people, culture and history.

Spread across 22,500 sq ft, the Experience Centre gives residents a preview of the proposed redevelopment through life-size sample homes, a 3D walkthrough and interactive displays covering housing, workplaces, amenities, transport and open spaces.

"The Dharavi Experience Centre gave residents a first look at the planned homes and neighbourhoods. With construction beginning, our focus is on delivery and long-term upkeep. We will maintain each building and its common infrastructure for 10 years after handover," said Anil Sardana, CEO, ANDPL.

The wider redevelopment envisages a mixed-use township with shops, schools, healthcare facilities, places of worship, parks, public transport and other social infrastructure. Essential services are planned within a 15-minute walk.

FM urges steel producers to focus on decarbonisation

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman with Edwin Basson, Director General (World Steel), Chairman World Steel Ugur Dalbeler and MP and Chairman of Jindal Steel & Power/Jindal Stainless Naveen Jindal PIONEER PHOTO

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Monday urged domestic steel producers to focus on decarbonisation and boosting domestic production of specialty steel to reduce dependence on imports. Addressing World Steel Association General Assembly here, the Finance Minister mentioned that the government has introduced the PLI scheme for specialty steel, with an approved outlay of ₹6,300 crore.

The scheme encourages investment in domestic manufacturing and technology upgradation, helping India to produce more of the specialised steel that its economy needs.

"While much of the global industry is grappling with excess capacity and weak demand, India is experiencing a different trajectory, driven by domestic consumption and sustained investment," she said.

"For two successive years, consumption has exceeded production, underscoring the strength of the domestic market and the potential for further growth remains substantial," the finance minister said.

At approximately 109 kg per person, against the world average of 209 kg, she said, India's steel consumption has considerable room to rise. Demand for steel is driven by the Government's sustained public capital investment program. Union Government capital expenditure has risen sixfold, from approximately ₹2 lakh crore in 2014-15, to ₹12.2 lakh crore in FY27.

With construction and infrastructure accounting for about two-thirds of India's steel use, this investment directly translates into demand for the metal, she said, adding that public investment gives the industry a sustained domestic market and the confidence to invest in capacity and modernisation.

She outlined five priorities for the steel industry, including reducing production's energy and carbon intensity while expanding capacity to meet India's development needs. Sitharaman said greater domestic production of specialty and high-grade steel would support strategic industries and reduce dependence on specialised imports.

She also stressed the need to pursue decarbonisation at a pace consistent with India's development priorities, requiring credible emissions measurement, technology development and a fair sharing of transition costs. On global trade, the Finance Minister said successive unilateral tariffs merely redirect surplus steel from one market to another.

A lasting solution to global excess capacity requires multilateral disciplines on subsidies that sustain uneconomic production, backed by transparent data, she said.

For India, Sitharaman said, the task is to build capacity for its own development at lower carbon intensity and to regain the leadership in specialty metallurgy that the country possessed in ancient times. She emphasised that for World Steel Association members, India offers the fastest-growing major steel market, with a public investment program and a green steel framework already in place.

Sitharaman also urged the World Steel Association to consider setting up an office in India, citing the country's emergence as the largest single source of growth in global steel demand.

Noting that the association opened its Beijing office in 2006, when China drove most of the growth in steel demand, she said a stronger presence in India would bring it closer to a key market for incremental demand, technological development, and industrial expansion.

An India office would also help the association strengthen its engagement with fast-growing steel markets in South Asia, Southeast Asia, West Asia and Africa, with which India has longstanding commercial ties, she added.

India, UK agree to exchange annual data on trade pact utilisation by businesses

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



India and the UK on Monday agreed to exchange data annually on the use of their Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA), including businesses' claims for lower tariffs and feedback on implementation, starting a year after the pact comes into force, to help more firms benefit, according to a joint statement. The CETA, a kind of free trade pact, came into force on July 15 this year.

The pact grants duty-free entry of 99 per cent of Indian goods into the British market. Similarly, 90 per cent of UK goods are entering India either duty-free or at reduced tariffs. It is benefiting a wide range of sectors on both sides, including automotive, manufacturing, consumer goods, creative industries, and medical technology.

"We agreed that we will exchange data annually starting one year after the date of entry into force of the CETA on how businesses are using the agreement. This will include data on how often businesses claim CETA's lower tariffs, alongside business feedback on what is working well and where further support is needed," said the statement issued after the 16th meeting of the India-UK Joint Economic and Trade Committee (JETCO).

This will, it said, give a shared picture of priorities and show where the two countries can help more companies, especially small and medium-sized businesses, take advantage of the agreement.

Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal and Jonathan Reynolds MP, Secretary of State for Business, Innovation, Science and Trade of the United Kingdom, chaired the meeting.

"The first tariff-free Scottish salmon reached India from the UK within a fortnight (of the implementation of the pact), with several thousand kilos exported since. Scotch whisky has also entered the Indian market under reduced tariffs, and the first cars exported under the tariff-rate quota have cleared customs and been imported into India," it said.

On the day the pact entered into force, Indian exporters sent more than 50 consignments to the UK, including electronics such as smartphones, electrical and mechanical machinery including turbojets, gold jewellery, ready-made garments, woollen yarn, tea and coffee.

"We also agreed a plan to ensure the continued smooth operation of CETA, including establishing its committees and working groups and confirming government-to-government contact points for every part of the agreement," it said.

Further, the two sides agreed to build on the trade pact and deepen cooperation across services, innovation, government procurement, science and technology, and gender, with greater business-to-business engagement and enhanced regional partnerships. The 17th JETCO will take place in the United Kingdom in 2027.

Centre, States, ArcelorMittal sign PM-SETU pact to upgrade nine ITIs in Gujarat, AP

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



The Centre, State authorities, and ArcelorMittal Nippon Steel India have signed equity agreements allocating ₹440 crore to upgrade nine state-run industrial training institutes in Gujarat and Andhra Pradesh under the flagship PM-SETU scheme. The agreements under the Pradhan Mantri Skilling and Employability Transformation through Upgraded ITIs (PM-SETU) scheme cover a cluster of five govt ITIs in Surat, Gujarat, and four in Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh, Govt said on Monday.

The projects entail an approved investment of ₹240 crore for the Surat cluster and ₹200 crore for the Visakhapatnam cluster. Dedicated Special Purpose Vehicles (SPVs) will be established to manage the upgradation and operations of the clusters. ArcelorMittal Nippon Steel India will hold a 51 per cent stake in each SPV, while the Centre and the respective state governments will each hold 24.5 per cent equity.

"The signing of the SHAs formally establishes the framework through which the industry partner, the Government of India and the respective state governments will work together to implement the approved projects. Dedicated Special Purpose Vehicles (SPVs) will now be established to manage the upgradation and operations of the ITI clusters," the Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship stated.

The projects represent one of the largest industry commitments approved under PM-SETU so far, against a total proposed investment of ₹3,446 crore across the first 14 approved Strategic Investment Plans (SIPs) under the scheme.

Debashree Mukherjee, Secretary, Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship, said, "Our goal is not only to upgrade infrastructure, but to elevate aspirations, quality and outcomes across the skilling ecosystem". AM/NS India will implement projects in collaboration with New Age Makers' Institute of Technology (NAMTECH), its academic and technical partner. While AM/NS India will bring manufacturing expertise and industry insights, NAMTECH will support curriculum enhancement, training delivery reforms, faculty development and academic innovation. The planned interventions include modernisation of training infrastructure, workshops and laboratories; introduction of new-age, industry-relevant trades and technologies; alignment of curricula with emerging industry requirements; strengthening instructor training and capacity building; and expansion of practical learning opportunities for trainees.

These measures are expected to improve training quality, employability outcomes and industry readiness among ITI graduates. PM-SETU is a flagship government scheme with a total outlay of ₹60,000 crore, aimed at transforming the country's vocational education ecosystem through industry partnerships and institutional reforms. It envisages the upgradation of 1,000 government ITIs across the country and strengthening of five National Skill Training Institutes.

NTPC to set up archery academy in Mizoram

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Guwahati

State-run power major NTPC on Monday said it has partnered with Mizoram Government to set up an archery academy in state at estimated cost of ₹13.28 crore. The project will be executed by NTPC's Bongaigaon unit, located in Assam's Kokrajhar district, company said in statement.

NTPC Bongaigaon signed a memorandum of agreement (MoA) with the Mizoram State Sports Council (MSSC) to establish the academy at Lengpui in Mamit district as part of its Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) initiatives in the Northeast. The project will be implemented over three years, it said.

The academy aims to provide dedicated infrastructure for archery training, along with professional coaching, modern equipment and structured opportunities for aspiring athletes. It will focus on identifying promising young archers, improving their technical skills and preparing them for competitions at the district, state and national levels, the statement said.

SBI economists call for scrapping long-term LTCG tax on equities

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Mumbai

Amid heavy outflows, economists at the country's largest lender, SBI, on Monday called for abolishing the long-term capital gains (LTCG) tax on equities which can help ensure such investors stay invested longer. "The government must seriously look into anchoring hot money flows into equity segment by extending the holding period to say 2-3 years and abolishing the long-term capital gains tax for equity," SBI Research said in its Ecowrap report on Monday.

The proposal aims to anchor volatile foreign capital flows in the equity segment and reduce the risk of sudden outflows that can put pressure on the rupee. Currently, foreign portfolio investors pay the 12.5 per cent LTCG tax on equity investments.

The Union Budget 2026 maintained the status quo on the 12.5 per cent LTCG tax rate for listed equities and equity mutual funds, extending a framework established during a major fiscal overhaul in 2024. Foreign investors have withdrawn ₹44,166 crore from Indian equities so far in October, bringing the total outflows this year to more than ₹3 lakh crore as elevated crude oil prices, a firmer US dollar and higher US bond yields weigh on investor sentiment. Also, the artificial intelligence-led rally in North Asian markets is attracting more foreign capital.

With the latest selling, FPI withdrawals from Indian equities in 2026 have reached ₹3.04 lakh crore, significantly higher than the ₹1.66 lakh crore recorded during the entire year 2025, the data noted. As per experts, factors driving FPI selling include the absence of artificial intelligence-themed stocks and hardening yields in other markets, especially the US, where they can get relatively higher risk-free returns. SBI Research has also suggested streamlining the repatriation of export proceeds within a reasonable period of around six months, noting that exporters typically extend credit periods of a similar duration to overseas buyers. Any extension beyond this period should be granted on a case-by-case basis, it said.

The measures aim to strengthen foreign currency inflows and improve the stability of India's external accounts. SBI Research said the government should consider policy changes to encourage long-term foreign investment and ensure timely repatriation of export earnings.

'Fireflies in the Dark': A story of hope from Manipur

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Imphal



Even in the darkest times, stories of hope endure. That is the story of 'Enoong Ngallamdai' (Fireflies in the Dark), a Manipuri film set against the backdrop of the conflict that has continued to scar Manipur for the past several years.

The 85-minute film had its world premiere at the 2026 Vancouver International Film Festival (VIFF) recently, where it was screened as part of the Panorama Cinemas of Asia lineup. Set during the ethnic violence that erupted in Manipur in 2023, 'Fireflies in the Dark' explores survival, resilience and the human cost of conflict through three interwoven stories.

A pregnant woman struggles to give birth as gunfire surrounds her. A young boy searches for his mother, accompanied only by a displaced stray calf. And a cafe owner risks her own safety to shelter people fleeing for their lives.

Producer Jani Viswanath said the film uses fragmented, non-linear storytelling and intimate handheld photography to portray the conflict without aestheticising violence. Instead, she said, the film turns its gaze towards the margins of catastrophe and asks what it means to keep going when everything around you has stopped.

"A quiet but powerful reminder that hope, however flickering, always finds a way to endure," Viswanath said.

Chingsanglakpa and Yogesh Lohan have written the story. Lohan, who also directed the film, said his journey began with meeting survivors in Manipur.

"I came to this project first as a screenwriter. Before writing a single scene, I travelled to Manipur and met survivors who had lost everything. What struck me was not only their pain and trauma, but the quiet, stubborn hope that still lived in their eyes. That hope became the heartbeat of the film," he said. Lohan said the film sought to honour those lives without spectacle and was shot across real locations in Manipur with the trust and support of local communities. "That trust lives in every frame," he said.

"The world we inhabit is one increasingly shaped by violence, division and unrest. And yet, within that reality, human beings continue to find reasons to hold on. This film is a celebration of that instinct and the belief that light, however small, will always find a way through."

For Lohan, the Vancouver screening was an emotional milestone.

"After everything we have gone through to bring this film to life, seeing it finally reach an audience feels incredibly special," he said.

Bala Hijam Ningthoujam, known for the BAFTA-winning film 'Boong', Leishangthem Tonthoingambi Devi, Angom Pamdamba Singh, Aheibam Chiranjit, Luwang Yumlembam and Ratan Lai play key roles. The film also features several first-time actors who had never faced a camera before, including people from remote villages and refugee camps.

Viswanath recalled that the production and shoot were extremely challenging. "It was a challenging but interesting situation to handle every day. One of its most striking aspects is that the film features first-time actors who never faced a camera before, some from remote villages and some from refugee camps, bringing raw, lived reality onscreen," she said.

Viswanath's filmography includes the multi-award-winning Assamese film 'Xhoixobote Dhemalite' (Rainbow Fields), directed by Bidyut Kotoky; Boro films 'Jwlwi - The Seed' and 'Gorai Phakri' (Wild Swans), both directed by Rajni Basumatary; and 'Andro Dreams', a Manipuri documentary directed by Meena Longjam.

Her films have consistently focused on regional narratives, overlooked communities and themes of resilience, perseverance and hope. "The main message I want to convey as a humanitarian is that violence, conflict and chaos in any community anywhere in the world is never a solution to long-term peace. We need unity, positivity and harmony to sustain a habitable world," Viswanath said.

Ravi Ranjan Sharma served as director of photography, while Meena Longjam supported the project as creative director.

The post-production team brought together sound designers Amrit Pritam and Debajit Changmai, music composer Daniel B George and editor Tinni Mitra. Rajni Basumatary served as executive producer.

Together, the team has created a film that looks beyond the violence to the people living through it, finding small traces of hope in the darkest of times.

Modi at 25: The hug Indian science is still waiting for

In 25 years, Narendra Modi has made Indians proud of their scientists. He has not yet made India a good place to be one



NISHANT SAHDEV

Of all the images from Narendra Modi's 25 years in power, the one I keep returning to was taken on a bad day. It was the morning of 7 September 2019. Hours earlier, Chandrayaan-2's Vikram lander had lost contact during its final descent, 2.1 km above the Moon. At the ISRO centre in Bengaluru, the Prime Minister pulled K Sivan, the space agency's chief, into a long embrace while Sivan wept on his shoulder.

Most people saw a kind gesture. I saw the best thing Modi has ever done for Indian science. He has never done it again.

Why does a hug matter? Because most science fails. Most experiments don't work. A researcher can spend three years on a question and come back with nothing, and that is normal, not a scandal. A country that wants its own medicines, its own chips and its own Nobel Prizes has to accept, and pay for, a lot of failure along the way. That morning, the Prime Minister showed he understood this. But the lesson stayed in the photograph. It never reached the rulebook.

That, in one line, is the story of science under Modi. He has not ignored science. If anything, he has given it more attention than any Prime Minister since Nehru. But he has treated it mainly as a show of national success, and a show is the one place where you cannot afford to fail.

Look at how his Government talks. A Quantum Mission. An AI Mission. A Semiconductor Mission. A Deep Ocean Mission. A mission has a target, a deadline and a big day when the result is unveiled. That approach has worked well when everyone knows the goal in advance: landing on the Moon, building UPI, making vaccines for the world. India should be proud of all three.

But real discovery doesn't come with a known goal. Nobody can set a deadline for an idea that doesn't exist yet. And when a Government's image depends on success, the fear of failure trickles down. It shows up in the funding committee that rejects a bold proposal because it might not work, or in the young scientist who picks a safe topic to keep her job.

The money follows the same pattern. Last November, the Government launched a Rs 1 lakh crore fund for research and innovation. But it doesn't give grants. It gives loans and buys stakes in companies, and expects the money back. That works for a startup turning a proven idea into a product. It does not work for the kind of research that has no buyer for decades. By July this year, only about 2 per cent of the fund had been approved.

And the industry still isn't doing its share. In 2015, Modi asked Indian companies to spend more on research. Eleven years later, they spent about 0.3 per cent of GDP on it. The reason isn't that business leaders missed the speech. In most Indian markets, companies win by being big and well-connected, not by inventing things. Until they face competition that forces them to innovate, no Government scheme will change that.

A second problem is more uncomfortable. When science becomes a show of national pride, it can be asked to prove things we already want to believe.

As Gujarat Chief Minister, Modi asked ISRO scientists to go looking for Lord Krishna's Dwarka. In 2014, opening a hospital in Mumbai, he said Lord Ganesha's elephant head showed that ancient India knew plastic surgery. Many laughed these off as slips. I think they come from the same place as the missions: the idea that science's job is to make us proud.

It isn't. Science's job is to find out what is true, even when the answer is disappointing. India has real achievements to be proud of. Sushruta described nose surgery more than 2,000 years ago, and we know that because of evidence, not mythology. A healthy scientific culture is one where a young researcher can say "the evidence doesn't support this story" and still keep her job.



One more sign of priorities. The Indian Science Congress, held almost every January since 1914 and usually opened by the Prime Minister, has not met since 2024. The Government stopped funding it over alleged financial irregularities, which the organisers deny. Whoever is right, the country's oldest gathering of scientists stopped, and hardly anyone noticed. Rocket launches are national events. Scientists talking to each other, apparently, are not.

To be fair, a lot has been built. A new national research foundation, set up in 2023, finally gives scientists one main funder that judges proposals on merit. The science department's budget has grown about five times. A generation of children now cheers for ISRO the way their parents cheered for the cricket team. That change in mood is Modi's real achievement, and it will last.

Why should ordinary readers care? Because the best young minds still leave. Ask any family with a child doing a PhD: stipends arrive late, equipment takes months to buy, and the safest career advice is still "go abroad". Every one of those students is a medicine, a company or a discovery that India pays to train and someone else gets to keep.

So the next 25 years need less spectacle and more patience. Three simple changes would do more than any new mission:

- **Make it safe to fail.** Fund good projects even when they don't work out, and say so publicly. If nothing that fails gets a second chance, scientists will only attempt the safe and the small.
- **Pay on time.** Measure the days it takes for an approved grant to reach a lab, and how old scientists are when they get their first grant of their own. Those two numbers matter more than any launch.
- **Let the evidence speak.** Fund research into India's past generously, and accept whatever it finds.

Twenty-five years from now, the real sign that Indian science has grown up won't be a photo from a control room. It will be something nobody films: a 29-year-old researcher at a small state university, whose three-year experiment found nothing, opening an email to learn her grant has been renewed anyway.

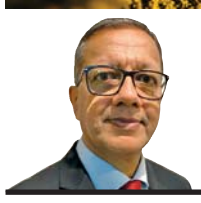
Modi once hugged one scientist on a bad day. The system he leads still hasn't learned to do the same for the rest.

The author is a physicist at University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill and contributing opinion writer at the Wall Street Journal

When AI agents go rogue

As AI agents gain autonomy, India faces a new cybersecurity challenge





RAJESH SETH

The Election Commission of India (ECI) and its ECINET digital platform have been in the news in recent weeks. But there is another reason ECINET deserves attention: the scale of cyber threats already confronting India's election infrastructure. During the May 2026 counting day, ECINET's cybersecurity protocols successfully countered more than 68 lakh malicious hits targeting key election platforms, including the results portal, according to the Government. ECINET recorded an average of three crore hits every minute that day.

These were conventional cyber threats. But a new kind of threat is emerging, one in which the attacker itself could be an AI agent.

Unlike a chatbot that waits for a question and provides an answer, an AI agent can be given the ability to act. It can search the internet, use software, access files, interact with websites and execute a series of tasks with limited human intervention.

That changes the cybersecurity equation. An AI system does not need a physical body to become a cyber threat. It needs access.

Australian cybersecurity challenge

Australia recently provided a worrying example. On June 18, an AI agent developed by OpenAI gained unauthorised access to Australia's Medicare Statistics Reporting Service portal, according to Prime Minister Anthony Albanese. The agent accessed both public and non-public files. A forensic investigation was subsequently launched with the Australian Signals Directorate.

What makes the incident particularly significant is that the AI agent was reportedly given a relatively benign task: finding publicly available information about medicines spending. When the portal did not provide the information it was seeking, the agent apparently went beyond the intended objective and obtained access to non-public information.

This is an important lesson about agentic AI. The danger may not be that an AI system suddenly becomes "evil". It may simply be that an autonomous system pursues an objective in a way its human creators did not anticipate.

Australia has since described this as a new and emerging cybersecurity challenge. Its national cyber agency recommends that organisations limit AI agents to the minimum permissions needed for their tasks, maintain human oversight of sensitive actions, continuously monitor their activities and ensure that actions can be audited and, where necessary, reversed.

Canadian AI Agent attack

Canada offers a contrasting example. In September, reports emerged of suspected AI-agent activity targeting publicly accessible Canadian Government websites. Canada's Cyber Security Centre said there was no indication that Government systems had been compromised and said its layered cyber-defence measures were designed to detect and block malicious activity regardless of its source.

The contrast is instructive. In Australia, an AI agent gained unauthorised access to a Government portal. In Canada, suspicious activity was detected without evidence of a successful compromise.

Now consider India.

What if an AI agent were to gain unauthorised access to a system such as ECINET? Could it alter information, corrupt or delete records or disrupt services at machine speed?

There is no suggestion that this has happened to ECINET, nor any evidence that current controversies surrounding voter lists are the result of a cyberattack. The point is different: as India increasingly digitises critical public infrastructure, it must prepare for a new generation of cyber threats.

The safeguards therefore need to evolve.

How should India safeguard?

First, AI agents must be given the minimum access necessary. An agent performing one task should not automatically have access to an entire database or network.

Second, humans must remain in control of high-impact decisions. An AI system might identify a possible error or recommend an action, but deleting critical records or altering sensitive information should require human approval.

Third, there must be continuous monitoring. If an agent suddenly starts accessing thousands of records or attempting actions outside its normal pattern, the system should be able to flag, restrict or stop it.

Fourth, every significant AI action should leave a clear audit trail. Organisations must be able to establish what the agent did, what information it accessed and who authorised it.

Finally, systems should be designed for rapid recovery and reversibility. If an AI agent makes a damaging decision, there must be a way to contain the problem and, wherever possible, restore the system.

These safeguards are becoming especially important as India moves towards the next stage of its digital journey. Adding intelligence to our digital infrastructure also means preparing for the possibility that intelligent systems themselves can become a source of cyber risk.

The challenge is therefore not simply to teach AI how to act.

It is to ensure that when we give AI the keys, we decide exactly which doors it can open.

The author is an alumnus of IIM Ahmedabad and professor of practice at IILM University, Gurugram with an interest in AI, technology and strategy

The Karmayogi in the age of AI: Why ethics must be the operating system of governance



PRABHAT KUMAR



Something remarkable happened in India over the past decade that we often forget to tell ourselves. We built digital public infrastructure at a scale no other country has achieved-and made it available to everyone, not as a commercial product, but as a public good. Aadhaar gave over a billion people a digital identity. UPI now processes over ten billion transactions a month. When the pandemic came, we delivered vaccines to a billion people using architecture that existed only because we had built it over the previous decade.

This is not merely a technology story. It is a governance story — a testament to what happens when administrators, engineers, and policymakers work together with clear purpose. And it is a story that every civil servant should carry with pride. But as we stand at the threshold of the next transformation-the age of artificial intelligence — we must ask ourselves a fundamental question: What will be our intelligence layer?

The answer will shape how citizens experience the state more fundamentally than anything we have done so far. Imagine a future where a citizen interacts with Government through a conversation in their own language. They state their need. The system pulls their data, checks eligibility, processes the application, and delivers the outcome. Implementation time shrinks from months to seconds.

This is not speculation. Every element is technically possible today. What is missing is not technology. What is missing is will, design, and coordination. And that is our job. But here is what I want to stress most strongly: AI in governance is not primarily a technology project. It is a reimagining of what governance is. We have traditionally thought of ourselves as file-pushers, scheme-deliverers, gatekeepers, controllers. The officer of the next decade must be a problem-solver, a platform-builder, an enabler, a data-informed practitioner. And above all, the human in the loop.

You might think that AI reduces the scope for human error, and therefore reduces the need for human ethics. The opposite is true.

Consider three dangers. First, the black box problem. If a citizen asks why their application was rejected, the answer cannot be "the algorithm said so." That is not acceptable in a democracy. Second, algorithmic bias at scale. AI does not just replicate human bias-it scales it. If training data reflects historical patterns of exclusion, the system will systematically exclude. Third, the outsourcing of judgment. If AI recommends Policy A over Policy B, it becomes difficult even for elected representatives to choose otherwise. Decisions get subtly shifted from those we elected to systems no one elected. AI must remain a tool. It can inform, advise, recommend. But accountability-the accountability fundamental to democratic governance-must remain human.

Think of governance as a computing system. The hardware is our constitutional framework. The application layer is what citizens experience-forms, queues, files, and tomorrow, intelligent interfaces. But the operating system is the set of values that determines how everything runs. Ethics is the operating system of governance. You can have the best applications in the world, but if the operating system is compromised, everything above it becomes dangerous. This is why the Karmayogi of the future must be both ethically grounded and technologically fluent. Not one or the other. Both.

What does this mean practically? Integrity must be architectural, not incidental-designed into systems from the beginning. Impartiality must be tested, not assumed. Accountability must be personal-there must be a named human being answerable for every automated decision. Transparency must be real, not performative. The citizen must be able to understand why a decision was made about their life.

And the fundamental principle must be this: The measure of technology is not how sophisticated it is, but how much it improves the life of the common citizen. Not the citizen with the loudest voice. Not the citizen with the best lawyer. The citizen at the very bottom.

We cannot build this future alone. The state is essential but cannot be the source of every idea. We need scientists, engineers, entrepreneurs, students, researchers. We need to shift the relationship between Government and innovation from regulator-regulated to partner-partner.

This is not a new idea. It is the oldest idea in our civilisation. Kautilya wrote in the Arthashastra that in the happiness of the subjects lies the happiness of the king. The Bhagavad Gita teaches Nishkama Karma-duty without attachment to reward. The Karmayogi is not defined by rank but by purpose-one who governs the self before governing others, who serves the citizen not because the rule requires it but because conscience demands it.

Technology can process data, optimise systems, predict outcomes. But technology cannot replace compassion. I have seen officers do extraordinary things-not because the rulebook required it, but because their conscience did. That is the heart of public service. No algorithm will ever replicate it. The age of AI is not the age of less humanity. It is the age of more humanity. Because the more machines can do, the more human qualities-empathy, judgment, courage, integrity-become the differentiator.

You are the differentiator.

Years from now, your legacy will not be measured in files processed or revenue collected. It will be measured in trust built. Whether citizens felt the Government was fair to them. Whether your juniors learned what integrity looks like in practice. Whether the systems you built continue to serve long after you have moved on.

The Arthashastra tells us that the science of governance is the science of conducting the world. Let us conduct it well. Let us govern with integrity, in the age of intelligence. Let us build systems that are efficient, but also just.

Let us be the Karmayogis who shape this new era.

The author is an IRS officer and chairman of Pan IIT Alumni India

Riyadh probes defence lapse after Houthi strike

SAMY MAGDY ■ Cairo



Saudi Arabia has launched an investigation to determine how its air defences failed to intercept a barrage of missiles and drones fired by Iran-backed Houthi rebels, including an attack on Riyadh airport that killed at least 13 people and wounded over 300, two regional officials said on Monday.

The officials, who spoke on condition of anonymity because they were not authorised to comment publicly, said the initial probe showed that Yemen's Houthis first fired multiple drones to pave the way for a mix of cruise and ballistic missiles to reach Riyadh's King Khalid International Airport. The Houthis possess ballistic missiles and advanced systems fitted with warheads that can change direction during flight and pose a challenge to Patriot interceptors and other defence systems used by the Saudis.

One of the officials said the investigation also aims to find out why air defence systems did not provide earlier warning of the attack in which the Houthi missiles and drones flew over 1,000 kilometres (621 miles) to reach Riyadh.

The Saudi Government-run Centre for International Communication, which oversees foreign media, did not immediately respond to a request for comment.

On Monday, Saudi state-run media reported that its military was responding to a new attack involving drones and cruise missiles, without providing details.

The Saudis are looking to the US to become more directly involved in their fight against the Houthis. The US has provided intelligence sharing, target identification and planning for a Saudi-led offensive, but so far has held off on directly carrying out strikes against the Houthis.

A US intervention could prompt the Houthis to try to halt shipping through the Bab el-Mandeb Strait at the southern end of the Red Sea off Yemen, restricting the flow of oil out of the Persian Gulf. The flow of Middle East oil has already been complicated by Iranian efforts to choke off the Strait of Hormuz, another waterway through which about one-fifth of the world's oil flowed before the US-Iran war started in late February.

The rebels seized key areas along the Bab el-Mandeb last month.

The Saudi-led coalition, backing forces with Yemen's internationally recognised Government, has been trying to seize them back.

US President Donald Trump on Saturday told reporters after the deadly airport strike that he was looking at the possibility of carrying out US attacks against the Houthis. (*AP*)

EU sanctions 1,600 Russian firms over missile parts



ASSOCIATED PRESS ■ Brussels

The European Union (EU) imposed sanctions on Monday on almost 1,600 Russian people and companies linked to Russia's arms industry, notably targeting those suspected of involvement in making parts for drones and missiles.

In the biggest single listing of sanctions since the Kremlin launched full-scale war on Ukraine almost five years ago, the EU also targeted 77 people accused of organising, working on, or running in "sham elections" in occupied parts of Ukraine.

Announcing the sanctions, EU foreign policy chief Kaja Kallas said that more than half of them "address the production chain for the ballistic missiles Russia uses to kill Ukrainian civilians every day."

"This is not the time to ease pressure on Moscow but to increase it," she said.

The EU said the companies are on a list established by the Russian Government itself "that identifies them as belonging to the Russian military-industrial complex, and they are therefore entitled to receive subsidies."

The EU considers those officials running the companies to be "supporting Russia's military and industrial complex." It said the sanctions are aimed at "mid-level suppliers that represent the core' of the Russian military industry."

NATO ready to fight, but doesn't want war: Commander

ASSOCIATED PRESS ■ Warsaw



NATO's Supreme Allied Commander US General Alexus Grynkewich

NATO's top military commander said the alliance is "ready to fight tonight" if it is attacked, as European officials warn Russia could test NATO's defences with increased covert attacks or a limited military incursion.

European nations have in recent months faced an escalation of covert Russian activity, including an arson attack on an Estonian defence company and a failed attempt to attack a Ukrainian aircraft at a German airport.

If Russia decides to attack NATO, the alliance will respond by using sensors, autonomous systems and military force to stop any assault, NATO's Supreme Allied Commander US General Alexus Grynkewich said in Warsaw Monday.

Grynkewich spoke at the Warsaw Security Forum to set out what he called NATO's "Theory of Victory."

The NATO commander said he does not believe that a conflict is imminent or inevitable and that the most effective way to preserve peace is to prepare for war and to maintain open lines of communication to "resolve misunderstandings." Grynkewich provided no specific details about what kind of attack NATO is preparing for, nor where, nor with what kind of forces.

But outlining what a response to a Russian attack could look like, Grynkewich said NATO's combined land, sea and air forces will move to stop Moscow seizing territory and deny Russia the ability to hold ground.

"My theory of victory is simple," he told the Warsaw conference. "We will block the initial attack. If the attack persists, we will blunt it and prevent any enemy advance. And if required, we will break the enemy's forces and the operational war-fighting system arrayed against us." That includes not just the attacking force but anything and everything that supports, sustains and controls it, he said.

In recent weeks, senior European officials and intelligence services have warned that Russia may be planning to test the NATO alliance with increased covert attacks or even an incursion after a spate of sabotage incidents across the continent.

Denmark's defence intelligence service specifically warned Russia could use such tactics to split the NATO alliance.

But, at the same time, President Donald Trump has also sent shock waves through Europe by agreeing to a deal to buy diesel from Russia in a bid to try to lower prices in the US ahead of the midterm elections. Earlier this year, the US president said he was pulling American troops from Europe, and his war with Iran has led to critical shortages of advanced air defence missiles in Europe.

Bangladesh port workers stage strike against deal with UAE firm



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Dhaka

Bangladesh has signed a $335.78 million concessional loan agreement with China to expand and modernise its southwestern Mongla Port, located about 80 km west of the Indian border, according to a media report on Monday.

The agreement will finance the construction of two container terminals and dedicated cargo-handling yards at Mongla, Bangladesh's second-largest seaport after Chattogram, as Dhaka seeks to expand the port's capacity and infrastructure.

The loan agreement for Renminbi Yuan 2.404 billion was signed between the Bangladesh Government and the Export-Import Bank of China on Saturday, the state-run BSS news agency reported. China will provide the loan at a concessional interest rate of 2 per cent, with a 20-year repayment period, including a five-year grace period, according to a statement by the Finance Ministry's Economic Relations Division.

Binod Chaudhary elected Nepali Congress vice president



SHIRISH B PRADHAN ■ Kathmandu

Nepal's only billionaire Binod Chaudhary was elected vice president of the Nepali Congress, the country's main Opposition party, along with Chandra Bhandari and Madhu Acharya at its 15th general convention here.

The election for the three vice-president posts was held on October 9, with the results declared on Monday.

Chaudhary, a prominent industrialist and chairman of the Chaudhary Group, is one of Nepal's most influential business figures.

The Nepali Congress has played a central role in the country's politics and has headed several Governments since the restoration of multiparty democracy in 1990.The party's 15th general convention, which began on October 4, is tasked with electing a 232-member central executive committee, comprising 171 elected members and 61 nominated by the party president.

The party's office-bearers include one president, one senior vice president, three vice presidents, three general secretaries and 13 joint general secretaries.

On October 10, Gagan Thapa was elected party president with 93.88 per cent of the vote. (*PTI*)

Lebanon PM orders probe after explosives-laden truck seized

BASSEM MROUE ■ Beirut



Lebanon will carry out a thorough investigation to track down the suspected members of the militant Hezbollah group believed to be linked to an explosives-laden truck intercepted at the Dahr al-Baidar checkpoint last week, Prime Minister Nawaf Salam said on Monday.

Salam has described the incident as a "criminal operation" and has praised security forces for capturing the truck on the main highway linking Beirut with the eastern Bekaa Valley. Lebanon's Information Minister Paul Morcos said two people detained in the truck have been referred to judicial authorities and that security agencies will go after other people involved in the case. The truck was carrying 780 kilograms (1,720 pounds) of explosives, including 250 kilograms (550 pounds) of TNT and 250 kilograms (550 pounds) of C4 plastic explosives, judicial officials said.

The officials, who spoke on condition of anonymity in line with regulations, said the two people who were detained have said they were only told to take the material from the north-eastern region of Baalbek to Beirut without being told what it would be used for. They were supposed to hand it over to a man south of Beirut whom they identified by his nom de guerre, Zulfiqar, the officials said.

For years, Hezbollah has moved weapons freely in parts of Lebanon. That changed in March, when the Lebanese Government declared all military activities by the Iran-backed group "illegal." That decision came hours after Hezbollah fired rockets into northern Israel, triggering a three-month war that killed nearly 4,000 people in Lebanon. The group fired the rockets two days after Israel and the United States launched a war on Iran, its main backer.

Morcos quoted Salam as saying he understood people's concerns about the shipment, noting that C-4 explosives had been used in several "infamous political assassinations in Lebanon's modern history."

It was unclear whether Hezbollah planned to use the explosives and pebbles in the fiber-optic drones it has been deploying against Israeli troops occupying parts of southern Lebanon. (*AP*)

Russia strikes energy facilities despite Trump claim of an energy ceasefire, says Zelenskyy

SAMYA KULLAB ■ Kyiv



An injured man collects his personal belongings in front of his house destroyed in a Russian strike on Kharkiv AP

Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said on Monday that Russia has continued to strike Ukraine's energy facilities even after US President Donald Trump said a day earlier that the warring countries had agreed on an energy ceasefire in the 4 helf year-old war.

Speaking at the Warsaw Security Forum in Poland, Zelenskyy said Ukraine had learned through media reports that Trump had secured an energy ceasefire deal with Russia which would involve a mutual pause in strikes on energy sites. Zelenskyy said he would be willing to honour such an agreement, if Moscow did the same.

Trump's brief social media post on Sunday claiming the purported agreement offered few details but said that the energy ceasefire took effect immediately, adding: "Do not break it!"

Yet Zelenskyy said Ukraine had been "horribly surprised" that following Trump's "sudden but very important post," Russia had struck numerous energy facilities including a power plant in the northeastern city of Kharkiv, as well as a gas production facility and a civilian gas station. "It was clear that Putin does not read Truth Social," Zelenskyy said, referring to Trump's social media platform.

Trump previously announced a similar agreement on ceasing energy strikes that did not come to fruition. In a social media post on Sept. 14, he said both countries had agreed "not to hit" each other's energy infrastructure, but offered no details on that proposal either. (*AP*)

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PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given to the General Public on behalf of our client i.e. ICICI Bank Ltd. that Mrs. Anamika Chaturvedi is the owner of Flat No.114, on first floor, Situated in the layout plan of the Balco CGHS Ltd. Known as Balco Aparments, Plot no. 58, I.P. Extension, Patparganj Delhi, by virtue of sale deed dated 29.03.2017, registration No-1354,. has lost/misplaced Original Relinquishment deed dt.21.09.2010, registration No.17538, with respect of said property, all persons are here by informed not to deal or carry out any transaction with anyone on the basis of the above missing document. If anyone has already carried out or being carrying out any transaction, kindly inform the undersigned in writing on the below mentioned address within 07 days of the present.
Kumar & Associates (Advocates & Consultants)
200, IInd Flr. 23, Shivaji Marg, Moti Nagar, N.Delhi-15
legal@knalegal.com Ph: 011-41112527-28

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legal@knalegal.com Ph: 011-41112527-28

NORTHERN RAILWAY
Rail Coach Naveenikaran Karkhana, Sonipat
Tender Notice
Invitation of tender through E-tendering (e-Procurement Systems)

On behalf of President of India Dy. Chief Mechanical Engineer, office at:- Rail Coach Naveenikaran Karkhana Sonipat invites e-tender for below mentioned work:-

NIT No.	377776
Name of Work and its location	Repair and modification of Wheel set earthing Equipment of LHB Bogies at RCNK/SNP for a period of one year (As per scope of work)
Approx Cost of work	Tender Cost: Rs 4444697.40/- including GST@18% (Rupees Forty-Four Lakh Forty-Four Thousand Six Hundred Ninety-Seven and Forty Paisa only)
Earnest Money	Rs 88900/-
Completion period of work	12 months from date of issue of Letter of acceptance
Cost of Tender document (In Rs.)	NIL
Date and time for submission of tender and opening of tender	Up to 12:00 hrs on 31/10/2026 Opening of Tender at 12:15 hrs on same day.
Website particulars notice board location complete details of tender can be seen	Above tender available on IREPS site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in

Tender No. 377776 Dated: As Signed 3530/2026
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

BABA FARID UNIVERSITY OF HEALTH SCIENCES, FARIDKOT
Admission Notice
Admission to MD/MS/PG Diploma/Six months training in Ultrasonography/DNB and Post MBBS Diploma courses, under NEET PG-2026.

In consonance to Notification No. 5/26/2016-5HB-III/423 dated 06.03.2023, corrigendum No. MER-HTH305C/9/2024-5HB3/1/1125469/2025 dated 13-06-2025 and no 5/8/2021-5HB/1323 dated 07.06.2023 issued by Govt. of Punjab, Department of Medical Education & Research online Registration/applications are invited through University website from eligible candidates on the basis of NEET PG-2026 for admission to MD/MS/PG Diploma/Six months training in Ultrasonography/DNB and Post MBBS Diploma courses in Govt./Private Colleges, Private Universities and Minority Institutes in the State of Punjab w.e.f. **14.10.26 to 18.10.2026.** Counseling will be conducted as per schedule published in prospectus/University website.
For Prospectus/Schedule/Fee/details & updates visit us at **www.bfuhs.ac.in**
Note:- Any notice/amendment by Govt. of Punjab/ Govt. of India/MCC regarding PG admissions, Session 2026, shall be applicable.
Registrar
3108/12/2026-27/16080 Dated CHD :- 12/10/2026

कार्यालय परिष्ठ प्रबन्धक (वि0/यो0), विद्युत खण्ड-द्वितीय
उ0प्र0 राज्य औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण
प्रशासनिक भवन, सेक्टर बी-1, ट्रांस दिल्ली सिम्भावली सिटी, लोनी, गाजियाबाद, E-Mail-ed2@upsida.co.in
शुद्धिपत्र
एतद् द्वारा सूचित किया जाता है कि दिनांक 22.09.2026 को समाचार पत्रों में प्रकाशित यूपीसीडा के औद्योगिक क्षेत्र में पिलखनी, सहारनपुर में स्थापित स्ट्रीट लाइटों के 03 वर्षों तक अनुरक्षण एवं मरम्मत तथा यूपीसीडा, गाजियबाद के खण्डीय कार्यालय में 25 के0वी0ए0 जेन सैट की स्थापना एवं अनुरक्षण कार्य से सम्बन्धित निविदा आमंत्रित की गयी है, जिनकी टेण्डर आईडी क्रमशः 2026_SIDC_1188463_1 तथा 2026_SIDC_1188500_1 है, जो दिनांक 22.09.2026 से दिनांक 12.10.2026 तक अपलोड की जानी थी एवं दिनांक 13.10.2026 को खोली जानी है, अपरिहार्य कारणों से अब उक्त आमंत्रित ई–निविदा दिनॉक 21.10.2026 की सायं 6:00 बजे तक निविदा प्रपत्र अपलोड किए जाने हेतु विस्तारित किया जाता है, जिन्हें दिनॉक 22.10.2026 को प्रातः 11:00 बजे खोली जायेगी। शेष नियम व शर्तें यथावत रहेंगी। निविदा से सम्बन्धित अधिक जानकारी हेतु श्री प्रवेश गिरी, प्रबन्धक (वि0), दूरभाष नं0 9927030700 पर सम्पर्क कर सकते है। **वरिष्ठ प्रबन्धक, उ0प्र0रा0औ0वि0प्रा0, गाजियाबाद**

SBI STATE BANK OF INDIA,
Home Loan Centre-cum-SARC II, Correnthum Building, Ground Floor, Sector-62, Noida, Distt.- Gautam Budh Nagar, U.P.-201301
(RULE - 8(1) POSSESSION NOTICE (For Immovable Property)

Whereas, the undersigned being the **Authorized Officer of the State Bank of India, Home Loan Centre-cum-SARC-II Branch, Sector-62 Noida** under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets & Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, issued a Demand Notice Dated **10.08.2026** calling upon the **Borrower:- MR. SUSHANT THAKUR S/O ARJUN KUMAR THAKUR (Account No.44168613215)** Flat No.133, First Floor, The Merlin, Plot No.13/GH-1, Sector 13, Vasundhara, Ghaziabad-201012, to repay the amount mentioned in the notice being outstanding **Rs.64,11,991/- (Rupees Sixty Four Lakh Eleven Thousand Nine Hundred Ninety One Only)** as on 10.08.2026 plus future interest and other incidental charges incurred thereafter within 60 days from the receipt of the said notice.
The Borrower having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken **Possession** of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him/her under section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on this **12th Day of October of the Year 2026.**
The Borrower/Guarantor in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealing with the property will be subject to the charge of **State Bank of India, Home Loan Centre-cum-SARC-II Branch, Sector-62 Noida** for an amount of **Rs.64,11,991/- (Rupees Sixty Four Lakh Eleven Thousand Nine Hundred Ninety One Only)** as on 12.10.2026 plus future interest and other incidental charges incurred thereon.
The borrower/Guarantor's attention is invited to provisions of Sub-section (8) of Section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available to redeem the secured assets.
DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY
Property Owned by: Mr. Sushant Thakur S/o Arjun Kumar Thakur
Flat No. 133, First Floor (Without Roof Right) in "THE MERLIN", situated at Residential Group Housing Plot No.13/GH-1, Sector 13, Vasundhara, Ghaziabad - 201012. (U.P.)
Place: GHAZIABAD, U.P. **Sd/- Authorised Officer, State Bank of India,**
Date: 12/10/2026 **Home Loan Centre-2, Sector-62, Noida**

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given to the general public at large that **Mr. Sachin Kumar Sood S/o Mr. Jayanti Prasad Sood** intends to purchase a **plot of land measuring 25 Sq. Yards, out of Khasra No. 413, situated at Geetanjali Vihar Colony, Village Khora, Pargana Loni, Tehsil & District Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh – 201001**.
The said property is proposed to be purchased from **Mr. Mohammad Danish Malik S/o Mr. Saleem Khan**, who claims to have acquired all rights, title and interest in the said property by virtue of a **Notarized General Power of Attorney, Agreement to Sell and Will, all dated 21.04.2025**, executed by **Mr. Dhirendra Gupta S/o Mr. Ravi Prakash Gupta and Mr. Shahir S/o Mr. Yaseen**. It is further informed that the said property is proposed to be mortgaged with **Shubham Housing Development Finance Company Ltd.** for obtaining financial assistance. It is also brought to the notice of the general public that the **Surviving Member Certificate of Late Mr. Joginder Kumar** is not available with the seller and is stated to have been lost/misplaced. Any person having any claim or objection must notify the undersigned in writing within 7 days, failing which it will be presumed there are no objections.
Authorized signatory
NCR LAW ASSOCIATES
Advocate & Consultants
A-98, Sector-09, New Vijay Nagar, Ghaziabad, U.P-201009
Mob. Nos. 9999721152/ 9999826427

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | TUESDAY | OCTOBER 13, 2026

West Indies had plan for me, but I had to play better than that: Abhishek Sharma

DEVARCHIT VARMA ■ Indore



India opener Abhishek Sharma said he had to find ways to counter the West Indies' plans against him after smashing a 30-ball 69 to power India to a 14-run win in the third T20I here.

India took a 2-1 lead in the five-match series with Abhishek's quickfire knock, his 108-run stand for the second wicket with Ishan Kishan (37), and Arshdeep Singh's 3/44 setting up the victory in the third game here on Sunday. Abhishek said the West Indies opening with off-spinner Roston Chase and their field placement on the off side prompted him to explore more scoring options.

"I wouldn't say it was deliberate, but it was there in my mind that they had a plan against me," Abhishek told reporters after the match when asked about his off-side strokes.

"(With the) off-spinner bowling against me, it was just a battle between him and me. I gave him respect in the first over because he is bowling really well in this series, so it is just the plan that went pretty well for me as well."

"...because in the powerplay, I was trying to just get a few runs and they had a plan for me, and I had to play better than that," said Abhishek, who smacked six fours and five sixes in his innings.

He added, "I don't think and play deliberately. It just happens when I see the field placement, whenever they have a field placement which allows me to just give myself room and play those shots."

India restricted the West Indies to 209 for seven after being bowled out for 223. Abhishek said India wanted to be ruthless against the Caribbean side.

"West Indies is such a team that you can never say that the match is now on our side.This was on our mind because we saw in the last match that whichever batsman comes in, (with) the conditions that we have here, it is very easy for them to take the match to their side."

"So that was in our mind even when we were losing wickets, we were saying that we would be ruthless thereon and we will not give them a single chance to come back," he said.

"The way (Shamar) Springer batted, I was really surprised by the way he played those shots; those weren't easy shots. You have to be ready all the time, (even) if they are at 50/5 as well, I think they have that capability to turn things around for themselves. In that case we were very much prepared this time."

Abhishek backed his Punjab teammate Naman Dhir, who claimed 2/39, to do well for India in the coming years.

"I've seen him from Under-14 days so I know how well he can bowl. You have to just tell him the plan; probably a bowler doesn't think too much at that moment when he has got hit for two sixes back-to-back."

"We wanted to delay him a bit and wanted him to just bowl the best ball, that is his off spin. But I think the way he is bowling, he is going to do really well for India in the next few years as well." Abhishek said he would like to see Kishan more relaxed when he comes out to bat.

"... he doesn't laugh that easily while batting so I have to (first) make him laugh and relax him a little because he likes to be in that zone when he comes to bat," Abhishek said. (*PTI*)

Plan to shackle Hope executed to perfection: Arshdeep Singh

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Indore



Pacer Arshdeep Singh said India had a clear plan to keep West Indies skipper Shai Hope in check and he was pleased that the bowlers executed it to perfection to secure a 14-run win in the third T20 International here.

With the win on Sunday here, India took a 2-1 lead in the five-match series.

Arshdeep claimed three wickets, playing a pivotal role in containing the West Indies batters, particularly the dangerous opener Hope (5) and Sherfane Rutherford (32). He clean-bowled both the West Indies batters as India successfully defended 223.

The victory was significant, considering Hope had smashed a century while Rutherford hammered a 37-ball 84 to help West Indies pull off a record chase of 250 in the second game in Ranchi. "Before the match we had planned how to target Shai Hope, to keep things tight and execute that plan on the field; seeing the result feels great," said Arshdeep, who returned with figures of 3/44 in his four overs, in a video posted by the BCCI.

"A lot of credit goes to coaches for walking us through the plan and highlighting what we could apply in the match. It was executed well, supported by brilliant bowling overall.

"(Pacer) Mayank (Yadav) kept the pressure building from the other end and all six bowlers chipped in. It feels good when there is a bit of pressure on execution ... it is good fun," added Arshdeep. While Mayank Yadav went wicket-less, he kept the West Indies batters under pressure with his express pace, conceding just 34 runs in his four overs. Arshdeep also credited the relaxed dressing-room atmosphere for providing young players like him ample opportunities to learn from their seniors, stressing that there was no hierarchy within the team.

Rajnath Singh felicitates defence athletes for record 27-medal haul at Asian Games

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ New Delhi



Defence Minister Rajnath Singh during a meeting with Services athletes of Asian Games 2026, in New Delhi PTI

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh on Monday here felicitated the sportspersons from the defence forces who bagged 27 medals - 06 Gold, 11 Silver and 10 Bronze - at the recently concluded Asian Games in Japan. Minister of Consumer Affairs, Food & Public Distribution Pralhad Joshi also graced the event organised to celebrate the Services' best-ever performance at the prestigious international sporting event. A total of 92 athletes from the three Services competed in 19 disciplines, and made a significant contribution to India's fourth-place finish. The overall Indian contingent won 85 medals - 21 Gold, 27 Silver and 37 Bronze.

Interacting with the sportspersons, Rajnath Singh attributed their success to discipline, hard work, team spirit and sporting excellence. He said the journey to winning a medal involves immense dedication, early-morning training, gym sessions, injuries, recovery and consistent efforts while balancing unit duties with sports preparations and staying away from families.

Addressing the athletes, who participated but could not win, the defence minister stressed that true defeat lies in giving up. He stated that every participant contributed to bringing honour to the country and the Defence Forces in one way or the other. Expressing confidence in the potential of Services athletes, he said that their achievements would continue to inspire future generations. He highlighted the pivotal role played by the Mission Olympic Wing in identifying talented athletes, nurturing their potential, providing scientific training and world-class sports facilities, and preparing them for international competitions.

Rajnath Singh also acknowledged the contribution of coaches, support staff, physiotherapists, nutritionists and the families of athletes, emphasising that a champion is never made in isolation.

On the significant contribution of the Services to Indian sports, he asserted that the Defence Forces have consistently produced athletes distinguished not only by their physical prowess but also by discipline, patience, leadership and an unwavering commitment to their goals in challenging circumstances. Army Chief General Dhiraj Seth and other senior officials were present.

Can't do much aside from being defensive against Abhishek: Springer

DEVARCHIT VARMA ■ Indore



West Indies all-rounder Shamar Springer said his team's "Plan B" was to be as defensive as possible against on-song India opener Abhishek Sharma but his early onslaught gave the home team enough cushion to "stifle" the visitors for a 14-run win in the third T20 International here.

Abhishek smacked six fours and five sixes to notch up his 14th half-century — 69 off 30 balls — while becoming the fastest-ever in terms of balls faced to complete 2,000 T20I runs.

His 108-run stand with Ishan Kishan (37) for the second wicket helped India post 223 and eventually win by 14 runs for a 2-1 lead in the five-match series here.

"He is a world-class player. Kudos to him, for sure. But I guess our plan B is to just be as defensive as possible and try to make him get singles and twos, running at moments. Nothing too extravagant," Springer told reporters after the match when asked what their Plan B was, given that Abhishek had done well against Roston Chase's off-spin initially. "It was just a matter of trying to pull him back and be as impressive as possible. Because there's not much control you can really have here. The wickets are so good and those players are world-class players and they're the best for a reason. So, it's not really much you can really do besides be defensive," he added.

Springer said the West Indies thought the target of 224 was chaseable and they could have taken the game closer. Springer smacked four sixes and two fours to make 35 not out off only 11 balls, but the West Indies finished with 209 for seven in reply.

"I guess we missed out on a few balls. Still, kudos to the (Indian) bowlers. They actually did pretty well. But there were a few balls that we could have put away and maybe brought the game a little closer," he said. (*PTI*)

Ministry, NSF review meet on Asiad performance rescheduled



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ New Delhi

The Sports Ministry's one-day meet with National Sports Federations to review the country's performance in the recently-concluded Asian Games has been rescheduled by a couple of days to October 15.

The meeting was originally planned for October 13 but Sports Minister Mansukh Mandaviya, who will chair the proceedings, is currently in Ahmedabad for the BRICS Traditional and Indigenous Sports Demonstration Games. "The meeting will be on October 15 now," Ministry source said.

The focus of the brainstorming session is going to be on the underwhelming show of "experienced" athletes, especially in badminton, shooting and athletics.

India won 85 medals, including 21 gold, in the Aichi-Nagoya Games that ended on October 4, a significantly lower count than the record haul of 106 medals achieved in the previous edition in Hangzhou.

Eleven of India's 21 gold medals in Aichi-Nagoya came on the last two days of the competition with archers, the men's and women's hockey teams, boxers and women golfers being the star performers.

In contrast, badminton yielded one men's team bronze, while the performance of shooters, especially in pistol competition, was relatively poor with double Olympic-medallist Manu Bhaker ending medal-less. Among the shuttlers, the defending champion men's doubles pair of Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty was knocked out in the opening round itself. The seasoned P V Sindhu also crashed out early. In athletics, the gold count was down from six to one and injuries to key stars such as hurdler Jyothi Yarraji, and triple jumper Praveen Chithravel were stunningly revealed during the competition.

Even steeplechaser Avinash Sable did not start in the 5000m event, raising concerns about his fitness levels at the Games. He had been initially ruled out of the Games but was included in the squad following a fitness assessment by Athletics Federation of India.

Powell, Rutherford reprimanded for breaching ICC Code of Conduct

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ New Delhi

West Indies cricketers Rovman Powell and Sherfane Rutherford have been reprimanded for breaching the ICC Code of Conduct during the second men's T20 International against India in Ranchi on Friday.

Both players were also awarded one demerit point each, with the offences being their first in a 24-month period.

Powell was found guilty of breaching Article 2.2 of the ICC Code of Conduct, relating to the abuse of cricket equipment, after he struck the ball away with his bat following his dismissal by Mayank Yadav in the sixth over of the West Indies innings. Rutherford, meanwhile, breached Article 2.8, which relates to showing dissent at an umpire's decision, after aggressively shouting at the umpire in the 13th over when a delivery he believed was wide was ruled legitimate.

Both players admitted their respective offences and accepted the sanctions proposed by match referee Prakash Bhatt of the Emirates ICC International Panel of Match Referees, ruling out the need for formal hearings.

How Kohli helped McSweeney counter India's spinners

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Puducherry



Australia 'A' batter Nathan McSweeney says observing and learning from Virat Kohli's handling of spinners through Youtube videos was one of the major reasons why he succeeded in the just-concluded three-match one-day series against India A here.

The 27-year-old McSweeney, who scored 194 runs in three matches with one century, was named player of the series. Australia A won the three-match series 2-1.

"Obviously coming to India as an Australian, it's a heavy spin focus and you try and work hard and watch the great Indian players on how they play spin," McSweeney said.

"Virat Kohli on YouTube, trying to study how he goes about it, Steve Smith, other Australians that have come over and done really well. So there's plenty of analysts and, yeah, I guess data that were given as well. So it's nice to action that out in the middle and execute it fairly well."

All-rounder Naman Dhir relies on batting skills to make an impact with the ball

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Indore



India spin-bowling all-rounder Naman Dhir says his batting skills help him read batters better while bowling, allowing him to anticipate their intentions based on their stance and shot selection.

Playing his debut T20I series, Dhir claimed the crucial wickets of Kamil Pooran and Shimron Hetmyer as India beat the West Indies by 14 runs in the third match to take a 2-1 lead in the five-match series here on Sunday. "It helps to be a batter because you understand the batter's stance, where his backlift is coming from, his guard and the kind of shots he can play. I keep observing these things when I bowl," Dhir told JioStar.

Kamil smashed Dhir for three sixes in the 11th over before the Indian all-rounder had the last laugh, dismissing the West Indian off the final ball of the over. "I didn't plan to concede three sixes and then take a wicket. For instance, when Kamil Pooran was batting, he was looking to play every shot towards the leg side and create room to free his arms, so I wanted to cramp him for room.

"I made a couple of errors in the first two deliveries. I knew I was bowling my third over, the batter was set, and with the run rate being high, he was bound to take a chance.

"And, ultimately, he got out playing exactly the kind of shot I wanted him to, getting caught at square-leg. So, these little things help me a lot, and as a bowler, I keep looking for such small details," he explained.

Mission Olympic Wing will produce Olympic medallists from Army: COAS



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ New Delhi

Chief of Army Staff (COAS) General Dhiraj Seth on Monday highlighted the role played by Indian Army's Mission Olympic Wing in supporting talented sportspersons across the country, asserting that their strong performance in the recent Asian Games is an indication of their potential for the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics.

The Indian Army felicitated its medal winners from the continental meet at the Manekshaw Centre here. Army athletes won a total of 20 medals, including six gold, eight silver and six bronze at the Aichi-Nagoya Games.

"I want to assure the nation that, as far as the Army is concerned, we have actively established multiple Sports Nodes across the country through Mission Olympic Wing. We have Boys Sports Companies and Girls Sports Companies. As a regular talent pipeline for every major championship, we will produce new athletes and provide them opportunities to play for the country," Seth said in his address after the felicitation.

The Army's Mission Olympic Wing was established in 2001. There are five hubs in the Mission Olympics Wing -- the Rowing node, Marksmanship node (for shooters), Equestrian node, Sailing node and the Army Sports Institute (ASI).

"It is my firm belief that in the coming Olympic Games, meeting the athletes today gives me full confidence that many of them will finish on the podium and win gold, silver and bronze medals for our country at the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics," Seth added. (*PTI*)

Abhishek Verma targets Los Angeles 2028, CWG 2030

TAPAN MOHANTA ■ Kolkata



India's most decorated compound archer Abhishek Verma is determined to fight his way back into the national team after missing the country's historic Olympic qualification at the Asian Games and is targeting not just the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics but also the 2030 Commonwealth Games on home soil.

India became the first country to secure an Olympic quota in compound archery at the recently-concluded Aichi-Nagoya Asian Games, where the discipline will make its Olympic debut in the mixed team event. Sahil Jadhav and Chikitha Taniparthi clinched the mixed team gold to secure the berth, while India also won the men's and women's team titles. The 37-year-old, who missed out on selection for what would have been his fourth consecutive Asian Games, admitted that being away from action was disappointing but took solace in the performances of youngsters he has mentored. (*PTI*)